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Categorical Semantics and Autonomous Theorem Proving

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Abstract

We develop a categorical framework for autonomous theorem proving by translating the problem of type inhabitation into a geometric graph exploration problem. Our main contributions are threefold.

First, we reformulate the functorial semantics of Generalized Algebraic Theories (GATs), leveraging Cartmell's Contextual Categories to explicitly translate the syntactic problem of type inhabitation into a geometric graph search space. Second, we extend the Calculus of Constructions with a GAT signature and construct its term model. Third, we design an Expansion Algorithm that exhaustively constructs the categorical search space of terms in both settings. We propose a Graph Neural Network-based Conjecturer-Prover architecture to guide and prune this search, overcoming the inherent combinatorial explosion, a severe limitation that we subsequently quantify by analyzing the super-exponential growth of the term search space in a foundational baseline of simply typed combinatory logic.

Resumen

Desarrollamos las herramientas necesarias para abordar la demostración autónoma de teoremas desde la teoría de categorías, traduciendo el problema de habitación de tipos en un problema de exploración geométrica de grafos. Nuestras contribuciones principales son las siguientes:

En primer lugar, reformulamos la semántica functorial de las Teorías Algebraicas Generalizadas (GATs), utilizando las Categorías Contextuales de Cartmell para traducir explícitamente el problema sintáctico de habitación de tipos en un problema geométrico de exploración de grafos. En segundo lugar, extendemos el Cálculo de Construcciones con una signature GAT y construimos su modelo sintáctico. En tercer lugar, diseñamos un Algoritmo de Expansión que construye de forma exhaustiva el espacio de búsqueda categórico de términos en ambos entornos. Proponemos una arquitectura Conjetrador-Demostrador basada en Redes Neuronales de Grafos para guiar dicha búsqueda, superando la explosión combinatoria inherente al problema. Cuantificamos este crecimiento superexponencial del espacio de búsqueda de términos en el entorno de la lógica combinatoria con tipos simples.

Introduction

Our ultimate goal in this thesis is to translate the syntactical problem of theorem proving into a geometrical graph-exploration problem.

The automated generation of formal mathematical reasoning remains a profound challenge at the intersection of proof theory and logic. At the core of this pursuit lies the Curry-Howard correspondence, an isomorphism between logic and computation [17]: mathematical propositions are interpreted as types, and the proofs of propositions are viewed as terms (or programs) inhabiting those types. Consequently, the problem of proving a theorem is reduced to the problem of finding a well-typed term in a formal type theory.

Modern proof assistants, such as Rocq (formerly Coq) [18] and Lean [10] leverage this correspondence using rich type theories like the Calculus of Inductive Constructions [9, 25]. While these environments enabled the formalization of highly complex mathematics, fully autonomous theorem proving with such rich frameworks remains an extremely difficult challenge. The primary obstacle is undecidability of type inhabitation in dependent type theories [12], and even for inhabited types, attempting to exhaustively construct a term of a given type results in a combinatorial explosion of the search space.

Traditionally, term generation has been approached from a purely syntactic perspective, and more recently through Large Language Models (LLMs). The starting point of our research was a problem proposed by Dr. Joost J. Joosten: how could we use LLMs to terms in Minimal Implicational Combinatory Logic. However, generating terms from syntax alone is difficult to guide heuristically, and the linear nature of language model generation forces early commitments that can prevent a proof from ever being found. Similar limitations have been observed by the Logical Intelligence team in [22].

Our study of Topos Theory [21], initially motivated by Lafforgue’s framework connecting it with Artificial Intelligence [19, 20], led to a pivotal realization: to overcome purely syntactic limitations, we needed to leverage the categorical semantics of type theories. Therefore, we reframed autonomous theorem proving as a structural graph exploration problem. To empirically test this geometric approach prior to adopting the full complexity of our subsequent categorical framework, we developed the `IMPLICA`

graph engine (consisting of ~ 7.000 lines of code) alongside the first iteration of the expansion algorithm.

Subsequently, with the aim of expanding outside Minimal Implicational Combinatory Logic, we started our research about Generalized Algebraic Theories (GATs) [6, 7] and the Calculus of Constructions [8]. They both offered a way of translating the syntax into categorical structures —namely Contextual Categories and Doctrines of Constructions [26]— to obtain term models that carry a rich geometric graph structure. The soundness of this translation is guaranteed by the term model being the initial object of the category of models of the underlying type theory. This is known as the Initiality Conjecture. The initiality of the term model for GATs was originally established by Cartmell [6, 7]; the initiality of the term model for CoC was established by Streicher [26]. The modern Initiality Conjecture, stated by Voevodsky [30], pertains to the much more complex Martin-Löf Type Theory, which remains beyond the scope of our current work, and that was proven by Brunerie and Lumsdaine [5].

In this categorical framework, the problem of finding a proof translates to finding a specific morphism within a relativized contextual category. With this idea in mind of using categories and neural networks, we formalized an expansion algorithm — a deterministic process that exhaustively builds the finite subcategories representing the search space of terms— specifically designed to work together with Graph Neural Networks (GNNs), and try to overcome the severe exponential growth inherent to any algorithm trying to exhaustively solve the problem.

Graph Neural Networks are used to navigate and prune the categorical search space. Considering our finite subcategories that form the known search space as graphs, they are the perfect inputs for message-passing neural networks. By training a GNN to classify nodes in the context graph (deciding which paths to expand, keep or delete), we can effectively guide the expansion algorithm, bypassing the combinatorial explosion and paving the way for efficient, autonomous theorem proving.

Objectives

We provide a reformulation of Cartmell’s models of GATs, so it fits more naturally with later extensions. Building on this, we extend the Calculus of Constructions to accommodate a GAT signature, define the corresponding term model. Then we introduce the Expansion Algorithm, a deterministic procedure for generating terms within the term models described above, specifically designed to interface with a Graph Neural Network so as to guide the search and counteract the combinatorial explosion inherent to exhaustive term construction. To ground this algorithm and build intuition, we provide a full implementation for Simply Typed Combinatory Logic ($\mathbf{CL}_{\rightarrow}$) —a tractable yet representative system— using *IMPLICA*, a custom graph engine written in Rust.

Finally, we present a design proposal for the GNN-based model, including a novel unsupervised Conjecturer-Prover training paradigm intended to optimize the expansion process toward efficient, autonomous theorem proving.

Prerequisites

This thesis bridges type theory, categorical semantics, and machine learning. While specialized categorical structures —such as Contextual Categories and Doctrines of Constructions— are introduced and defined within the text, a basic familiarity with the fundamental concepts of category theory (e.g., categories, functors, and pullbacks) is assumed. For readers seeking an introduction or a refresher on this foundational material, Awodey’s *Category Theory* [2] is an excellent and highly recommended reference, particularly due to its focus on logic and computer science. As a more classical reference, there is Mac Lane’s *Categories for the Working Mathematician* [23].

Thesis Outline

This thesis is structured to guide the reader from the abstract categorical foundations to the practical implementation of AI-guided theorem proving:

- **Chapter 1: Syntax and Semantics of Generalized Algebraic Theories.** We introduce Cartmell’s Generalized Algebraic Theories and define their syntax and semantics, as they were originally presented in [6, 7] and incorporate some notions presented by Streicher in [26]. Then we provide a concept of model of a GAT together with a proof of the initiality of the term model. Finally, we define the problem of type inhabitation in categorical terms, and present the foundational Expansion Algorithm.
- **Chapter 2: Calculus of Constructions.** We present the syntactical definition of CoC together with the construction of Doctrines of Constructions as models for CoC, given by Streicher in [26]. We extend the definition of CoC to include a GAT signature and define the new term model. Finally, we extend our categorical problem definition and Expansion Algorithm to handle this richer syntax.
- **Chapter 3: Implementation of the Expansion Algorithm.** We demonstrate the raw Expansion Algorithm generating terms of Simply Typed Combinatory Logic ($\text{CL}_{\rightarrow}$) using `IMPLICA`, a custom Rust-based graph engine written by the author (consisting of ~ 7.000 lines of Rust code). Finally, we outline the architecture for integrating Graph Neural Networks using a novel unsupervised ‘Conjecturer-Prover’ training paradigm to optimize the expansion process.

Chapter 1

Generalized Algebraic Theories

In this chapter, we introduce Generalized Algebraic Theories (GATs), a framework for working with dependent types. GATs allow us to construct the concept of *contextual category*, the foundational categorical structure to deal with dependent types. We use contextual categories as a baseline for interpreting the more complex Calculus of Constructions in Chapter 2. Near the end of Chapter 1, we formalize the *term generation problem* and introduce the expansion algorithm, our approach to term generation.

1.1 Syntax of GATs

Generalized Algebraic Theories, originally presented by J. Cartmell in his thesis [6, 7], is an abstraction of Martin-Löf type theory and is a generalization of the usual notion of a many-sorted algebraic theory in the following manner: while in Martin Löf’s many-sorted algebraic theories sorts are constant types, interpreted as sets, in generalized algebraic theories sorts might be constant or variable, over a specified range of types. Variable types are interpreted as families of sets. We start by giving some intuition, and we will later give the formal definition.

Informally, a generalized algebraic theory consists of:

1. a set of sorts, that can be constant or variable;
2. a set of operators, with the sorts of the arguments and the sort of the value specified;
3. a set of axioms, where each axiom is an identity between expressions.

To build intuition, we consider the theory of categories. The set of sorts contains two elements *Ob* and *Hom*, standing for ‘objects’ and ‘homomorphisms’ respectively. *Ob* is a constant type and *Hom* is a variable type; for any two terms x, y of type *Ob*, we have a type $Hom(x, y)$. Here, we see a key feature of GATs: types vary over terms,

not over types¹. The set of operators also has two elements id and $\circ$. The id operator has one argument x of type Ob , and returns a value of type $Hom(x, x)$. This shows how the type of the value of an operator might vary depending on the arguments. The $\circ$ operator (or composition) expects 5 arguments: three terms x, y, z of type Ob , one term f of type $Hom(x, y)$, and one term g of type $Hom(y, z)$. It returns a value of type $Hom(x, z)$. Here we see that the type of an argument might also vary depending on a previous argument. Informally, instead of writing $\circ(x, y, z, f, g)$ we can write $\circ(f, g)$, as the first three arguments might be inferred from the last two. This notation is discussed in the original paper [7].

Now we introduce the notation we will be using when talking about terms and types. This notation will be formally defined in a later section. Given a set of variables V , we associate types to variables as required. When asserting that a term t is of type A , we write $t : A$. But if t has variables $x_1, \dots, x_n$ occurring in it, this assertion does not make sense unless we assign some types to $x_1, \dots, x_n$. To do this, we write

$$x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \vdash t : A$$

that reads as follows: if x_1 is a variable of type $A_1, \dots$ and, if x_n is a variable of type A_n , then t is a term of type A . Similarly, if we want to assert that if x_1 is a variable of type $A_1, \dots$ and if x_n is a variable of type A_n , then A is a type, we can write:

$$x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \vdash A \text{ type}.$$

Such assertions are called *rules* or *sequents*. Instead of considering expressions or judgments as basic units, we use rules, as both expressions and judgments make sense only within a context.

Axioms are also written as rules. The conclusion of those rules are equalities between types or between terms of the same type. We write those rules as

$$x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \vdash A = A' \quad \text{and} \quad x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \vdash t = t' : A$$

that read as: if x_1 is a variable of type $A_1, \dots$ and x_n is a variable of type A_n , then $A = A'$, or $t = t'$ as terms of type A , respectively. We will be writing $x, y : A$ to mean $x : A, y : A$, as a shorthand notation.

To continue with the previous example, we can write the axioms of category theory

¹This corresponds to the *dependent types* axis of Barendregt's λ -cube —the dimension that extends the simply-typed λ -calculus by allowing types to be indexed by terms (λP in cube notation). The canonical reference is [3].

as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}
x, y: Ob, f: Hom(x, y) &\vdash \circ(id(x), f) = f: Hom(x, y), \\
x, y: Ob, f: Hom(x, y) &\vdash \circ(f, id(y)) = f: Hom(x, y), \\
w, x, y, z: Ob, f: Hom(w, x), g: Hom(x, y), h: Hom(y, z) \\
&\vdash \circ(\circ(f, g), h) = \circ(f, \circ(g, h)): Hom(w, z).
\end{aligned}$$

When presenting a theory's language, i.e., the sets of sorts and operators, we must present each symbol with a rule specifying the role of this symbol, either as a sort symbol or as specifically typed operator symbol. These rules are called *introductory rules*. In the case of a sort symbol A , the rule should be like

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A(x_1, \dots, x_n) \text{ type}$$

clearly specifying the types A is dependent on. In the case of an operator symbol, a rule of the form

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash F(x_1, \dots, x_n): A$$

suffices to specify the types of the arguments and the type of the value of F .

Finally, to present a theory we give a set of symbols, each associated to its introductory rule, and a set of axioms. And, of course, everything must be well-formed, something we will address shortly. Now we give a slightly more formal presentation of category theory using GAT notation: in Table 1.1 we state the symbols of the theory together with their introductory rules and in Table 1.2 we state the axioms of the theory as rules.

Symbol	Introductory Rule
Ob	$\vdash Ob \text{ type}$
Hom	$x, y: Ob \vdash Hom(x, y) \text{ type}$
$\circ$	$x, y, z: Ob, f: Hom(x, y), g: Hom(y, z)$ $\vdash \circ(f, g): Hom(x, z)$
id	$x \in Ob \vdash id(x): Hom(x, x)$

Table 1.1: Symbols and their introductory rules.

Now we formally define all of the concepts we just introduced. To give a notion of well-formed introductory rule, we need the concept of derivability, which also depends on the introductory rules. To tackle this problem, we leave the question of well-formedness aside until we have the complete set of derived rules of a theory. We first

Axioms

$$\begin{aligned}
& x, y: Ob, f: Hom(x, y) \vdash \circ(id(x), f) = f: Hom(x, y) \\
& x, y: Ob, f: Hom(x, y) \vdash \circ(f, id(y)) = f: Hom(x, y) \\
& w, x, y, z: Ob, f: Hom(w, x), g: Hom(x, y), h: Hom(y, z) \\
& \vdash \circ(\circ(f, g), h) = \circ(f, \circ(g, h)): Hom(w, z)
\end{aligned}$$

Table 1.2: Axioms (left unit, right unit, associativity).

define a pre-theory and then define a theory as a well-formed pre-theory.

We assume given a countable set of variables V . Let us define the notion of rule on an alphabet W , whose elements are called *symbols*.

Definition 1.1. The set of *expressions* $\mathcal{E}$, is defined inductively so that expressions are finite sequences of elements of $W \cup V \cup \{(\cdot) \cup \{\cdot\}\} \cup \{, \}$ defined by the following clauses:

1. if $x \in V$, then x is an expression;
2. if $L \in W$, then L is an expression;
3. if $L \in W$ and $e_1, \dots, e_n$ are expressions, then $L(e_1, \dots, e_n)$ is an expression.

Remark 1.2. Non-arity-respecting expressions are expressions, but they have no means to enter the calculus.

Now we can define the building blocks of a rule:

Definition 1.3. A *premise* is defined to be a sequence of elements of $V \times \mathcal{E}$. The empty sequence is allowed and we call it an empty premise. We denote the premise $((x_1, A_1), \dots, (x_n, A_n))$ as $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n$.

Definition 1.4. We call a *conclusion* to one of the following:

1. *T-conclusion*: defined by a single expression A and written as ' A type'.
2. $\in$ -conclusion: defined by a pair of expressions (t, A) and written as ' $t: A$ '.
3. $T=$ -conclusion: defined by a pair of expressions (A_1, A_2) and written as ' $A_1 = A_2$ '.
4. $\in=$ -conclusion: defined by a triple of expressions (t_1, t_2, A) and written as ' $t_1 = t_2: A$ '.

Finally a *rule* is determined by a premise P and a conclusion C , and is written as $P \vdash C$. We name the rule as T -rule, $\in$ -rule, T =rule or $\in$ =rule according to the form of the conclusion.

Now we can define a *pre-theory* and later a *theory*.

Definition 1.5. A *pre-theory* consists of

1. a set of sort symbols $\mathcal{S}$;
2. a set of operator symbols $\mathcal{O}$;
3. for each sort symbol $A \in \mathcal{S}$, an associated rule of the alphabet $\mathcal{S} \cup \mathcal{O}$:

$$x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \vdash A(x_1, \dots, x_n) \text{ type}$$

for some $n \geq 0$. It is called the *introductory rule* of A ;

4. for each operator symbol $F \in \mathcal{O}$, an associated rule of the alphabet $\mathcal{S} \cup \mathcal{O}$:

$$x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \vdash F(x_1, \dots, x_n) : A$$

for some $n \geq 0$. It is called the *introductory rule* of F ;

5. a set of axioms. Where each axiom is either a T =rule or a $\in$ =rule of the alphabet $\mathcal{S} \cup \mathcal{O}$.

Now we tackle the problem of well-formedness of rules.

Definition 1.6. The set of *derived rules* of a pre-theory U is the set of rules derivable by the derivation rules presented in Appendix A.1.

Definition 1.7. If U is a pre-theory, then

1. a *context* is a premise $x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$ such that the rule

$$x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_{n-1} : A_{n-1} \vdash A_n \text{ type}$$

is a derived rule such that x_n is distinct from all of $x_1, \dots, x_{n-1}$;

2. (a) the rule $\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}$ is *well-formed* if the premise Γ is a context;
- (b) the rule $\Gamma \vdash t : A$ is *well-formed* if $\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}$ is a derived rule of U ;
- (c) the rule $\Gamma \vdash A = A'$ is *well-formed* if $\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}$ and $\Gamma \vdash A' \text{ type}$ are derived rules of U ;
- (d) the rule $\Gamma \vdash t = t' : A$ is *well-formed* if $\Gamma \vdash t : A$ and $\Gamma \vdash t' : A$ are derived rules of U .

Definition 1.8. A pre-theory is *well-formed* if all of its introductory rules are well-formed. A *theory* is a well-formed pre-theory.

Lastly, we introduce *substitution*. Given the expressions $\Delta, t_1, \dots, t_n$ and the variables $x_1, \dots, x_n$, we define the expression $\Delta[x_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow t_n]$ as the result of simultaneous replacement of $x_1, \dots, x_n$ in Δ by $t_1, \dots, t_n$. We call this the *substitution operation*. Then, as proven in the original paper [7], the set of derived rules of a theory is closed under the operation of substitution of correctly typed terms for variables, i.e., that we can substitute a variable x of type A in an expression only by terms t such that we can derive that $t : A$. We could add substitution as one of the derivation rules, but that would make applying induction very messy.

To transition from syntax to geometry (which our Graph Neural Network will eventually navigate), we construct a category out of the theory syntax.

Definition 1.9. For a theory U , we define the *category of contexts and realizations*, denoted $R(U)$. This category has as objects the contexts of U . Given two contexts $\Gamma = x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$ and $\Delta = y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$ of U , a morphism from Γ to Δ , or a *realization* of Δ from Γ , is an m -tuple $\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle$ such that for each j , with $1 \leq j \leq m$, the rule

$$\Gamma \vdash t_j : B_j[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_{j-1} \leftarrow t_{j-1}]$$

is derivable. We define the identity of an object $x_1 : \Delta_1, \dots, x_n : \Delta_n$ is the realization $\langle x_1, \dots, x_n \rangle$, and composition is defined as

$$\begin{aligned} \langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle \circ \langle s_1, \dots, s_w \rangle = \\ \langle s_1[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m], \dots, s_w[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m] \rangle \end{aligned}$$

for $\Gamma = x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$, $\Delta = y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$ and $\Omega = z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w$ contexts, and $\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle : \Gamma \rightarrow \Delta$ and $\langle s_1, \dots, s_w \rangle : \Delta \rightarrow \Omega$ realizations.

Now we study some properties of this category. First, we see that it has a tree structure.

Definition 1.10. A tree is a pair (N, parent) where N is a nonempty set of nodes and $\text{parent} : N \rightarrow N$ is a function such that:

1. for all $A \in N$, there exists $n \in \omega$ such that $\text{parent}^n(A) = \text{parent}^{n+1}(A)$;
2. for all $A, B \in N$, if $A = \text{parent}(A)$ and $B = \text{parent}(B)$, then $A = B$.

We write $A \sqsubseteq B$ if $A = \text{parent}(B)$ and $A \triangleleft B$ if $A \sqsubseteq B$ and $A \neq B$. By Condition 2, there is a unique least element of N , which we call 1. Finally, we define, for any $A \in N$, $\text{level}(A)$ to be the least $n \in \omega$ with $\text{parent}^n(A) = \text{parent}^{n+1}(A)$. We consider $\leq$ to be the transitive completion of the relation $\sqsubseteq$. We can see that the set of objects of $R(U)$, i.e., the set of contexts of U , is structured as a tree with the empty context as its least element and $\text{parent}(\langle x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \rangle) = \langle x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_{n-1} : A_{n-1} \rangle$. Moreover, given a context $x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n, x_{n+1} : A_{n+1}, \dots, x_{n+m} : A_{n+m}$ of U , $\langle x_1, \dots, x_n \rangle$ is a realization of

$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n$ with regard to $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n, x_{n+1}: A_{n+1}, \dots, x_{n+m}: A_{n+m}$, and is denoted as $p(\langle x_1: A_1, \dots, x_{n+m}: A_{n+m} \rangle, \langle x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \rangle)$. Hence, if we consider $\Gamma, \Delta \in \text{Ob } R(U)$ such that $\Gamma \leq \Delta$, then $p(\Delta, \Gamma)$ is defined and $p(\Delta, \Gamma): \Delta \rightarrow \Gamma$ in $R(U)$.

Additionally, for contexts $\Gamma = x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n$, and $\Gamma' = y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m$, and $\Delta = y_1: B_1, \dots, y_{m+w}: B_{m+w}$, and morphism $f = \langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle: \Gamma \rightarrow \Gamma'$ in $R(U)$,

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f^* \Delta & \xrightarrow{q(f, \Delta)} & \Delta \\ p(f^* \Delta, \Gamma) \downarrow & & \downarrow p(\Delta, \Gamma') \\ \Gamma & \xrightarrow{f} & \Gamma' \end{array}$$

is a pullback diagram in $R(U)$, where

$$\begin{aligned} f^* \Delta &= x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n, \\ &\quad y_{m+1}: B_{m+1}[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m], \dots, y_{m+w}: B_{m+w}[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m] \\ q(f, \Delta) &= \langle t_1, \dots, t_m, y_{m+1}, \dots, y_{m+w} \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

This motivates the definition of Contextual Categories.

1.2 Contextual Categories

Definition 1.11. A *contextual category* consists of

1. a category $\mathcal{C}$ with a terminal object 1;
2. a function $\text{parent}: \text{Ob } \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \text{Ob } \mathcal{C}$ such that $(\text{Ob } \mathcal{C}, \text{parent})$ is a tree, and 1 is the root of the tree, i.e., $\text{parent}(1) = 1$;
3. for each object A of $\mathcal{C}$ different from 1, a morphism $p(A): A \rightarrow \text{parent}(A)$, called *canonical projection of A* , which we write as $A \twoheadrightarrow \text{parent}(A)$;
4. for all objects A, B in $\mathcal{C}$ with $A \triangleleft B$ and all morphisms $f: C \rightarrow A$, an object $f^* B$ of $\mathcal{C}$ such that $C \triangleleft f^* B$, and a morphism $q(f, B): f^* B \rightarrow B$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f^* B & \xrightarrow{q(f, B)} & B \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ C & \xrightarrow{f} & A \end{array}$$

is a pullback in $\mathcal{C}$ that satisfies the following *functoriality conditions*:

- (a) if A and B are objects in $\mathcal{C}$ such that $A \triangleleft B$, then

$$\text{id}_A^* B = B \quad \text{and} \quad q(\text{id}_A, B) = \text{id}_B;$$

(b) whenever

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} & & & & B \\ & & & & \downarrow \\ A & \xrightarrow{f} & A' & \xrightarrow{f'} & A'' \end{array}$$

is given in $\mathcal{C}$, then

$$(f' \circ f)^* B = f^*(f'^* B) \quad \text{and} \quad q(f' \circ f, B) = q(f', B) \circ q(f, f'^* B).$$

We have that $R(U)$ is structured as a contextual category. The problem with $R(U)$ is that semantically equal but syntactically different rules are interpreted as different elements. Hence we define an equivalence relation $\equiv$ between derived T - and $\in$ - rules as follows:

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A_{n+1} \text{ type} \equiv y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m \vdash B_{m+1} \text{ type}$$

if and only if $m = n$ and, for each $1 \leq i \leq n + 1$,

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_{i-1}: A_{i-1} \vdash A_i = B_i[y_1 \leftarrow x_1, \dots, y_{i-1} \leftarrow x_{i-1}]$$

is derivable. Similarly,

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t: A \equiv y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m \vdash s: B$$

if and only if

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A \text{ type} \equiv y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m \vdash B \text{ type}$$

and

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t = s[y_1 \leftarrow x_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow x_m]: A$$

is derivable.

We define the *context category* of U , denoted by $C(U)$, as the category of equivalence classes of contexts and of equivalence classes of realizations. Two contexts $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n$ and $y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m$ are equivalent if and only if

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_{n-1}: A_{n-1} \vdash A_n \text{ type} \equiv y_1: B_1, \dots, y_{m-1}: B_{m-1} \vdash B_m \text{ type}$$

and two realizations

$$\begin{aligned} \langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle: \langle x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \rangle &\rightarrow \langle y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m \rangle \\ \langle s_1, \dots, s_m \rangle: \langle x'_1: A'_1, \dots, x'_n: A'_n \rangle &\rightarrow \langle y'_1: B'_1, \dots, y'_m: B'_m \rangle \end{aligned}$$

are equivalent if and only if, for each j , $1 \leq j \leq n$,

$$\begin{aligned} x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t_j: B_j[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_{j-1} \leftarrow t_{j-1}] &\equiv \\ x'_1: A'_1, \dots, x'_n: A'_n \vdash s_j: B'_j[y'_1 \leftarrow s_1, \dots, y'_{j-1} \leftarrow s_{j-1}]. \end{aligned}$$

It follows that $C(U)$ is itself a contextual category.

Definition 1.12. If $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}'$ are contextual categories, then a *contextual functor* is a functor $F: \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}'$ such that:

1. $F(1) = 1$ and if $A \triangleleft B$ in $\mathcal{C}$, then $F(A) \triangleleft F(B)$ in $\mathcal{C}'$;
2. for every object A of $\mathcal{C}$, $F(p(A)) = p(F(A))$;
3. for all f and B such that f^*B is defined in $\mathcal{C}$,

$$F(f^*B) = F(f)^*F(B) \quad \text{and} \quad F(q(f, B)) = q(F(f), F(B)).$$

Con denotes the category of contextual categories and contextual functors.

Now, we address some important properties of contextual categories we will be using later.

The first useful result is about projections. Although we defined projections on pairs $A \triangleleft B$, we might extend the notion to pairs $A \leq B$ defined as

$$p(B, A) = p(X_1) \circ \cdots \circ p(X_n) \circ p(B),$$

where $X_1, \dots, X_n$ is the unique sequence of objects in $\mathcal{C}$ such that $A \triangleleft X_1 \triangleleft \cdots \triangleleft X_n \triangleleft B$ in $\mathcal{C}$. In the case where $A = B$, we take $p(B, A) = id_A$. Notation: $B \rightarrow A$.

In type theory, proving a theorem often requires working under a set of assumptions (a context). In categorical semantics, ‘assuming a context A ’ corresponds to taking the relativization of $\mathcal{C}$ to A , noted as $\mathcal{C}_A$. More formally:

Definition 1.13. let $\mathcal{C}$ be a contextual category and A an arbitrary object of $\mathcal{C}$. Then we define the *relativization* of $\mathcal{C}$ to A as the contextual category where:

1. The objects of $\mathcal{C}_A$ are the objects B of $\mathcal{C}$ such that $A \leq B$.
2. For objects B, C in $\mathcal{C}_A$, a morphism from B to C in $\mathcal{C}_A$, also referenced as a morphism from B to C over A , is a morphism $f: B \rightarrow C$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that $p(C, A) \circ f = p(B, A)$. Composition of morphisms is inherited from $\mathcal{C}$.
3. $parent_A(B) = parent(B)$ if $A < B$, and $parent_A(A) = A$.
4. For objects $B > A$, $p_A(B) = p(B): B \rightarrow parent(B)$.
5. For B, C, D objects of $\mathcal{C}_A$ with $parent_A(D) = C$ and morphisms $f: B \rightarrow C$, we write

$$f^{*A}D = f^*D \quad \text{and} \quad q_A(f, D) = q(f, D).$$

Now we see that any morphism $f: B \rightarrow A$ in $\mathcal{C}$ induces a pullback functor $f^*: \mathcal{C}_A \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_B$ which is a contextual functor. This functor can be thought as a way of embedding the knowledge over the context A onto the context B , and also is used as a form of variable substitution. The proofs of the following theorems are included in [26].

Lemma 1.14. *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a contextual category, and $f: B \rightarrow A$ a morphism in $\mathcal{C}$. Then, for any object D with $D \geq A$, we define an object $f^*D \geq B$ and a morphism $q(f, D): f^*D \rightarrow D$ by induction over $\text{level}(D) - \text{level}(A)$:*

1. if $D = A$,

$$f^*D = B \quad \text{and} \quad q(f, D) = f;$$

2. if $D > A$,

$$f^*D = q(f, \text{parent}(D))^*D \quad \text{and} \quad q(f, D) = q(q(f, \text{parent}(D)), D).$$

Then, if $D \geq A$, the pair $(p(f^*D, B), q(f, D))$ is a pullback cone over $(f, p(D, A))$.

Theorem 1.15. *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a contextual category and $f: B \rightarrow A$ a morphism in $\mathcal{C}$. By mapping an object C of $\mathcal{C}_A$ to f^*C in $\mathcal{C}_B$, and mapping $g: C \rightarrow D$ over A to $f^*g: f^*C \rightarrow f^*D$ over B determined by*

$$\begin{aligned} p(f^*D, B) \circ f^*g &= p(f^*C, B) \\ q(f, D) \circ f^*g &= q(f, C) \end{aligned}$$

we obtain a contextual functor $f^: \mathcal{C}_A \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_B$ called reindexing along f .*

Theorem 1.16. *Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a contextual category and $f: B \rightarrow A$, $g: C \rightarrow B$ be morphisms in $\mathcal{C}$. Then,*

$$g^* \circ f^* = (f \circ g)^* \quad \text{and} \quad q(f \circ g, D) = q(f, D) \circ q(g, f^*D)$$

for objects $D \geq A$.

Definition 1.17. [26] Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a contextual category, A and B be objects of $\mathcal{C}$ such that $A \triangleleft B$. The set of *sections* of B is defined as

$$\text{Sections}(B) := \{s: A \rightarrow B \mid p(B) \circ s = \text{id}_A\}.$$

If $\text{level}(B) = 1$, then

$$\text{Sections}(B) = \{s \mid s: 1 \rightarrow B\},$$

as any morphism $s: 1 \rightarrow B$ satisfies $p(B) \circ s = \text{id}_1$ since 1 is a terminal object. In this case, the notion of section matches the notion of *global element* of B . The concept of section of a context $\langle x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n, y: B \rangle$ is the categorical equivalent of a term of type B under context $\langle x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \rangle$.

1.3 Relevance of the Context Category

The context category is the first example of what it is called a *term model*. This means that it is a category built directly from the syntax of a theory without picking any particular mathematical interpretation. This gives us the ‘most generic’ model of that theory. The three main properties of these models are the following:

1. **Soundness:** Any model of such theory corresponds to a structure preserving functor out of the term model.
2. **Completeness:** A judgement is provable/derivable in the theory if it holds in all models, or equivalently if it holds in the term model.
3. **Initiality:** The term model is often the initial object of the category of all models.

Because of completeness, navigating the context category $C(U)$ of a theory U is equivalent to manipulating the syntax of U .

We start by stating the completeness of $C(U)$ by the following completeness theorem that arises naturally from the definition of $C(U)$:

Theorem 1.18 (Completeness Theorem). *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be the canonical interpretation of a theory U in $C(U)$.*

1. *The T-rule $\Gamma \vdash A$ type is derivable if and only if $\Gamma, x : A$ is a context, i.e., if $[\Gamma, x : A]$ is an object of $C(U)$.*
2. *The $\in$ -rule $\Gamma \vdash t : A$, for $\Gamma = x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$, is derivable if and only if*

$$[\langle x_1, \dots, x_n, t \rangle] : [\Gamma] \rightarrow [\Gamma, x : A]$$

is a section of $[\Gamma, x : A]$ in $C(U)$.

3. *If the T-rules $\Gamma \vdash A_1$ type and $\Gamma \vdash A_2$ type are derivable, then the rule $\Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2$ is derivable if and only if $[\Gamma, x : A_1] = [\Gamma, x : A_2]$, where x is a variable that does not appear in Γ .*
4. *If the $\in$ -rules $\Gamma \vdash t : A$ and $\Gamma \vdash s : A$, for $\Gamma = x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$, are derivable, then the rule $\Gamma \vdash t = s : A$ is derivable if, and only if, $\langle x_1, \dots, x_n, t \rangle$ and $\langle x_1, \dots, x_n, s \rangle$ are equal sections of $[\Gamma, x : A]$ in $C(U)$, where x is a variable not appearing in Γ .*

Now we prove the initiality of $C(U)$, a special case of Voevodsky’s Initiality Conjecture [30]. In order to do it, we need to define interpretation of a theory U in a contextual category, and see that the canonical interpretation into $C(U)$ is the initial object of the category of interpretations of U .

Definition 1.19. Given a contextual category $\mathcal{C}$ and a theory U , an *interpretation* of U in $\mathcal{C}$ is a mapping $\mathcal{M}$ from the T - and $\in$ -rules of U to the $\mathcal{C}$ such that

1. if R is the derived T -rule $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A$ type and we name the rules $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_{i-1}: A_{i-1} \vdash A_i$ type as R_i for $1 \leq i \leq n$, then $\mathcal{M}[R_1], \dots, \mathcal{M}[R_n], \mathcal{M}[R]$ are objects of $\mathcal{C}$ such that $1 \triangleleft \mathcal{M}[R_1] \triangleleft \dots \triangleleft \mathcal{M}[R_n] \triangleleft \mathcal{M}[R]$ in $\mathcal{C}$.
2. if R_t is a derived $\in$ -rule $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t: A$ then $\mathcal{M}[R_t]$ is section of $\mathcal{M}[R]$.
3. if $\Gamma \vdash A = A'$ is a derived T =rule, then if we name $\Gamma \vdash A$ type as R and $\Gamma \vdash A'$ type as R' , then $\mathcal{M}[R] = \mathcal{M}[R']$.
4. if $\Gamma \vdash t = t': A$ is a derived $\in$ =rule, then if we name $\Gamma \vdash t: A$ as R_t , $\Gamma \vdash t': A$ as $R_{t'}$ and $\Gamma \vdash A$ type as R , then both $\mathcal{M}[R_t]$ and $\mathcal{M}[R_{t'}]$ are sections of $\mathcal{M}[R]$, and $\mathcal{M}[R_t] = \mathcal{M}[R_{t'}]$.

There is a *canonical interpretation* $\mathcal{M}$ of U in $\mathcal{C}(U)$, defined as follows:

1. if $R \equiv x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A$ type is a derived T -judgement, then we define

$$\mathcal{M}[R] = [x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n, x_{n+1}: A];$$

2. if $R_t \equiv x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t: A$ is a derived $\in$ -judgement, then we define

$$\mathcal{M}[R_t] = [\langle x_1, \dots, x_n, t \rangle]$$

a section of $\mathcal{M}[R]$.

The Completeness Theorem 1.18 guarantees that $\mathcal{M}$ is well defined.

Now we define the concept of homomorphism between interpretations of a theory U .

Definition 1.20. Let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}'$ be two contextual categories, and let $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}$ and $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}'}$ be two U -interpretations in $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}'$ respectively. An *interpretation homomorphism* is a contextual functor $F: \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}'$ such that:

1. if R is a T -rule, then $F\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}[R] = \mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}'}[R]$;
2. if R_t is an $\in$ -rule, then $F\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}[R_t] = \mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}'}[R_t]$.

So we define the category $\mathbf{Con}_U$ as the category with pairs of contextual categories and U -interpretations and their homomorphisms. We can easily see that $(\mathcal{C}(U), \mathcal{M})$ is an initial object of $\mathbf{Con}_U$. Consider an object $(\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{N})$ of $\mathbf{Con}_U$. Let us construct a morphism $F: ((\mathcal{C}(U), \mathcal{M})) \rightarrow (\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{N})$, i.e., we have to construct a contextual functor $F: \mathcal{C}(U) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}$ that commutes with the interpretation functions. If $[\Gamma]$ an object of $\mathcal{C}(U)$, then there is a T -rule R^Γ such that $\mathcal{M}[R^\Gamma] = \Gamma$. We define $F\Gamma = \mathcal{N}[R^\Gamma]$. In order to

define F on the morphisms of $C(U)$, it suffices to define it for the sections of $C(U)$, as any morphism

$$[\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle]: [x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n] \rightarrow [y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m]$$

can be built by composition and pullback functors of sections and projections, and the latter is uniquely determined by the condition that F is a contextual functor. Hence, given a section $s = [\langle x_1, \dots, x_n, t \rangle]$ of $[x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n, x: A]$, by definition there exists a derived $\in$ -rule R_t such that $\mathcal{M}[R_t] = s$, so we can define $Fs = \mathcal{N}[R_t]$. The uniqueness of F follows from the structure preservation conditions, as F is uniquely determined by the image of the introductory rules of sort and operator symbols. Hence, $(C(U), \mathcal{M})$ is an initial object of $\mathbf{Con}_U$.

Soundness comes from the initiality of $C(U)$, as any model of U , i.e., any element of $\mathbf{Con}_U$ is equivalent to the initial morphism F we just defined.

1.4 Expansion Algorithm for GATs

In this section, we give a formal definition of our problem, proposed at the beginning of the thesis, and reformulate it to an equivalent problem easier to solve. Then we propose an algorithm to solve such problem, that is designed to work together with artificial intelligence. Such optimization is discussed in Chapter 3.

Our problem might be formalized in the following manner: Given a theory U and a derived rule of U of the form

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A \text{ type},$$

we want to find an expression t of U such that the rule

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t: A$$

is a derived rule of U .

This problem is undecidable, in general, as it follows from the undecidability of the inhabitation in a GAT, or of dependent type theories [12]. This is why we will not try to find an algorithm that either finds a term or says that the type is empty. We aim to find an algorithm that, in case that the type is inhabited, it finds a term in a finite number of steps. In case that the type is empty, it does not have to terminate.

We can consider this problem from the point of view of the context category $C(U)$, where by the Completeness Theorem 1.18 it is rephrased as follows: Given a context $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n, x: A$ in U , we want to find a section of $[\Gamma, x: A]$ in $C(U)$, for $\Gamma = x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n$.

We can restrict our search to the *relativization* of $C(U)$ to $[\Gamma]$, that we denote as $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$. We denote a morphism $\langle x_1, \dots, x_n, t_{n+1}, \dots, t_{n+m} \rangle$ in $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$, as $\langle t_{n+1}, \dots, t_{n+m} \rangle_\Gamma$.

Now we define the *expansion algorithm* that will be responsible of finding $\langle t \rangle_\Gamma$ in $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$.

First, consider a finite subcategory G of $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$ which contains

$$[\Gamma, x: A] \rightarrow [\Gamma].$$

The process consists of the construction of a sequence $\{G_i\}_i$ of finite subcategories of $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$ such that $G_0 = G$, and that G_{n+1} is computed by the process described below from G_n , and where $G_n \subseteq G_{n+1}$ for all $n \geq 0$. We say that an object or morphism of $\mathcal{C}_\mathcal{A}$ is *constructible by expansion* if there exists an $n \geq 0$ such that the given object or morphism is contained in G_n . The process of constructing G_{n+1} from G_n consists of applying the following rules to each context $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m$ of G_n :

E1 For each sort symbol S with a well-formed introductory rule

$$z_1: C_1, \dots, z_n: C_m \vdash A(z_1, \dots, z_w) \text{ type}$$

such that G_n contains sections

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_1: C_1] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\ &\vdots \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_w \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]] \end{aligned}$$

then we add the context $[\Delta, y: A(t_1, \dots, t_w)]$ to G_{n+1} .

E2 Add the morphisms

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, x_i \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, x: A_i] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, y_j \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, y: B_j] \end{aligned}$$

for each $1 \leq i \leq n$ and each $1 \leq j \leq m$.

E3 For every operator symbol F with a well-formed introductory rule

$$z_1: C_1, \dots, z_w: C_w \vdash F(z_1, \dots, z_w): C$$

if the following sections exist in G_n :

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_1: C_1] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_2: C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\ &\vdots \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_w \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_w: C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]] \end{aligned}$$

then we add the section

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, F(t_1, \dots, t_w) \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, z: C[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]].$$

E4 For every morphism

$$[\langle t_1, \dots, t_{m-1} \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w] \rightarrow [\Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_{m-1} : B_{m-1}]$$

we construct the corresponding pullback in G_{n+1} :

$$\begin{array}{ccc} [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w, & \xrightarrow{[\langle t_1, \dots, t_{m-1}, y_m \rangle_\Gamma]} & [\Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m] \\ y_m : B_m[t_1 \leftarrow y_1, \dots, t_{m-1} \leftarrow y_{m-1}]] & & \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w] & \xrightarrow{[\langle t_1, \dots, t_{m-1} \rangle_\Gamma]} & [\Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_{m-1} : B_{m-1}] \end{array}$$

Finally, we complete G_{n+1} by adding the compositions of all of its morphisms. When we say we add a morphism, it is implied that we also add both endpoints, and when adding an object, we are also adding its projection.

Now we prove that every object and every morphism of $\mathcal{C}_A$ are constructible by expansion. Note that as projections are added together with the object, hence by asserting the existence of an object we are implying the existence of its projection. But to do so, we introduce the concept of *depth* of an expression in order to prove a the result by induction. This definition is inspired by the one in the next chapter taken from [26].

Definition 1.21. By structural induction of expressions, we define a function *depth* mapping the set of expressions and premises to ω :

1. if x is a variable, then $\text{depth}[x] = 1$;
2. if A is a sort symbol, and $t_1, \dots, t_n$ are expressions, then

$$\text{depth}[A(t_1, \dots, t_n)] = 1 + \sum_{i=1}^n \text{depth}[t_i];$$

3. if F is an operator symbol, and $t_1, \dots, t_n$ are expressions, then

$$\text{depth}[F(t_1, \dots, t_n)] = 1 + \sum_{i=1}^n \text{depth}[t_i];$$

4. if $\Gamma = x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$ is a premise, then

$$\text{depth}[\Gamma] = \sum_{i=1}^n \text{depth}[A_i].$$

Lemma 1.22. Every object and every section of $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$ are constructible by expansion.

Proof. We perform this proof by induction over the *degree* of the objects and sections, where

1. if Δ is a context over Γ , then

$$\text{degree}[\Delta] = \text{depth}[\Delta] - \text{depth}[\Gamma];$$

2. if $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$ is a context and $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma]$ is a section of $[\Delta, x : A]$, then

$$\text{degree}[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma] = \text{degree}[\Delta] + \text{depth}[t],$$

together with a secondary induction on derivation length.

Consider then a context $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$. We want to see that $[\Delta]$ is constructible by expansion. As Δ is a context, we have that

$$\Delta' \vdash B_m \text{ type}$$

is a derived rule of U , where we denote $\Delta' = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_{m-1} : B_{m-1}$. This implies that Δ' is itself a context, and by induction hypothesis, as

$$\text{degree}[\Delta] = \text{degree}[\Delta'] + \text{depth}[B_m] \geq \text{degree}[\Delta'] + 1 > \text{degree}[\Delta'],$$

we have that $[\Delta']$ is constructible by expansion. Moreover, as the rule $\Delta' \vdash B_m \text{ type}$ can only be derived by CF2(A), there exists a sort symbol S with a well-formed introductory rule

$$z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w \vdash A(z_1, \dots, z_w) \text{ type}$$

and derived rules

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta' \vdash t_1 : C_1 \\ \Delta' \vdash t_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\ \vdots \\ \Delta' \vdash t_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}] \end{aligned}$$

such that $B_m = A(t_1, \dots, t_m)$ as expressions. This means that these are sections:

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] \rightarrow [\Delta', z_1 : C_1] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] \rightarrow [\Delta', z_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\ \vdots \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] \rightarrow [\Delta', z_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]]. \end{aligned}$$

And clearly, as

$$\begin{aligned} \text{degree}[\Delta] &= \text{degree}[\Delta'] + \text{depth}[A(t_1, \dots, t_m)] > \\ &> \text{degree}[\Delta'] + \text{depth}[t_j] = \text{degree}[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m \rangle_\Gamma] \end{aligned}$$

for every j , with $1 \leq j \leq w$, they are all constructible by expansion by induction hypothesis. Finally, by applying the expansion rule E1, we have that $[\Delta]$ is constructible

by expansion.

Now, consider a section $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma]$ of $[\Delta, x: A]$. By definition, the rule

$$\Delta \vdash t: A \quad (1.1)$$

is a derived rule of U . We have that $\text{degree}[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma] = \text{degree}[\Delta] + \text{depth}[t]$, hence by induction hypothesis $[\Delta]$ is constructible by expansion. We now study how the rule (1.1) was derived. As it is an $\in$ -rule, it must have been derived by either T1, CF1 or CF2(A). We treat each case separately:

T1 Then, there exists an expression A' such that both $\Delta \vdash t: A'$ and $\Delta \vdash A = A'$ are derived rules of U . The latter rule gives us that $[\Delta, x: A] = [\Delta, x: A']$, hence we have to see that the section $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma]$ of $[\Delta, x: A']$ is constructible by expansion. As the length of the derivation of $\Delta \vdash t: A'$ is at least one T1 application shorter than the derivation length of $\Delta \vdash t: A$, by secondary induction, we have that the section is constructible by expansion.

CF1 Then, there exists an i , with $1 \leq i \leq n$, such that $t = x_i$ and $A = A_i$; or there exists a j , with $1 \leq j \leq m$, such that $t = y_j$ and $A = B_j$. We just prove the first case, as the other proof is equivalent. So as $[\Delta]$ is constructible by expansion, by applying the expansion rule E2 to it, we get that the section

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, x_i \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, x: A]$$

is constructible by expansion.

CF2(A) Then, there is an operator symbol F , with a well-formed introductory rule

$$z_1: C_1, \dots, z_w: C_w \vdash F(z_1, \dots, z_w): B$$

and derived rules:

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta \vdash t_1: C_1 \\ \Delta \vdash t_2: C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\ \vdots \\ \Delta \vdash t_w: C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}] \end{aligned}$$

such that $t = F(t_1, \dots, t_w)$ and $A = B[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]$. Then, as

$$\begin{aligned} \text{degree}[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, F(t_1, \dots, t_w) \rangle_\Gamma] &= \text{degree}[\Delta] + \text{depth}[F(t_1, \dots, t_w)] > \\ &> \text{degree}[\Delta] + \text{depth}[t_j] = \text{degree}[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_j \rangle_\Gamma] \end{aligned}$$

for all j , with $1 \leq j \leq w$, by the induction hypothesis, the following sections are

constructible by expansion:

$$\begin{aligned}
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] &\rightarrow [\Delta', z_1 : C_1] \\
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] &\rightarrow [\Delta', z_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\
&\vdots \\
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] &\rightarrow [\Delta', z_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]].
\end{aligned}$$

Then by applying the expansion rule E3, we get that the section

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, x : A]$$

is constructible by expansion. $\square$

Theorem 1.23. *Every object and every morphism of $\mathcal{C}_A$ are constructible by expansion.*

Proof. From the last lemma we have that both objects and sections are constructible by expansion. We now have to prove that any morphism is constructible by expansion. Let $[\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m] \rightarrow [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w]$ be a morphism on $\mathcal{C}_\Gamma$. We denote $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$. Then we know that the rules

$$\begin{aligned}
\Delta \vdash t_1 : C_1 \\
\Delta \vdash t_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\
&\vdots \\
\Delta \vdash t_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]
\end{aligned}$$

are derivable rules of U . So, by applying the lemma, we have that the following sections are constructible by expansion:

$$\begin{aligned}
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_1 : C_1] \\
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\
&\vdots \\
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]].
\end{aligned}$$

Now we show that the morphism

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1, \dots, t_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w]$$

is constructible by expansion. To do this, we prove that, given j with $2 \leq j \leq w$, if

$$\begin{aligned}
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1, \dots, t_{j-1} \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_{j-1} : C_{j-1}] \\
[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_j \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_j : C_j[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{j-1} \leftarrow t_{j-1}]]
\end{aligned}$$

are constructible by expansion, then so is

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1, \dots, t_j \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_j : C_j].$$

By the previous lemma, the object $[\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_j : C_j]$ is constructible by expansion, and by applying the expansion rule E4 on it, the following diagram is constructible by expansion:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} [\Delta, z_j : C_j [t_1 \leftarrow z_1, \dots, t_j \leftarrow z_j]] & \xrightarrow{\langle t_1, \dots, t_{j-1}, z_j \rangle_\Delta} & [\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_j : C_j] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \Delta & \xrightarrow{\langle t_1, \dots, t_{j-1} \rangle_\Delta} & \Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_{j-1} : C_{j-1} \end{array}$$

and by composition we get that

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1, \dots, t_{j-1}, z_j \rangle_\Gamma] \circ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_j \rangle_\Gamma] = [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1, \dots, t_j \rangle_\Gamma]$$

is constructible by expansion. It remains to see that the morphism

$$[\langle z_1, \dots, z_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w] \rightarrow [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w]$$

is constructible by expansion. As $\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w$ is a context, by Lemma 1.22, $[\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_j : C_j]$ is constructible by expansion. And by repeated application of the rule E4 gives us the following diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} [\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w] & \xrightarrow{\langle z_1, \dots, z_w \rangle_\Gamma} & [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ [\Delta, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_{w-1} : C_{w-1}] & \xrightarrow{\langle z_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \rangle_\Gamma} & [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_{w-1} : C_{w-1}] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ \vdots & & \vdots \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ [\Delta, z_1 : C_1] & \xrightarrow{\langle z_1 \rangle_\Gamma} & \Gamma, z_1 : C_1 \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ [\Delta] & \xrightarrow{\langle \rangle_\Gamma} & \Gamma \end{array}$$

This completes the proof of Theorem 1.23. □

Chapter 2

Calculus of Constructions

In Chapter 1, we established a pipeline for autonomous theorem proving: take a theory, translate its syntax into a Contextual Category, and reframe proof-finding as the geometric problem of finding a section in a graph.

In this chapter, we scale up the complexity to the Calculus of Constructions (CoC). Introduced by Coquand and Huet [8], CoC is a powerful higher-order typed lambda calculus. It serves as the foundation for the Calculus of Inductive Constructions [9, 25], the type theory powering modern proof assistants like Rocq (formerly Coq) [18].

The primary additions in CoC, compared to Generalized Algebraic Theories (GATs), are the following:

1. **Product Types (Π -types):** These are first-class citizens, meaning dependent function types exist at the base level rather than just in the theory's signature.
2. **The Universe of Propositions (*Prop*):** A type universe whose terms are themselves types, allowing for higher-order logic and universal quantification over types.

We define syntax of CoC, map it to a richer categorical structure called Doctrine of Constructions, and extend our Expansion Algorithm to navigate this new, highly complex search space.

2.1 Syntactic Formulation

In this section, we formally define the syntax of Calculus of Constructions. We use the approach of Streicher in [26], since the original definition in [8] is characterized by its syntax overloading, making it much harder to follow. The latter just use $[x : A]B$ to present product types, functional abstraction and universal quantification. Also, properties are presented as terms of type *Prop* and as types themselves. To make

our notation more readable, we will be using a type constructor *Proof* that, given a proposition $p : Prop$, yields $Proof(p)$, the type of proofs of proposition p .

First, we define the class of *pre-well-formed type expressions*, ranged over by capital letters, and the class of *pre-well-formed object expressions*, ranged over by lower case letters, by mutual recursion using Backus-Naur form [1]:

$$\begin{aligned}
 E ::= & \quad (\Pi x : E) E && \text{product of types} \\
 & \quad | Prop && \text{type of propositions} \\
 & \quad | Proof(t) && \text{type of proofs of proposition } t \\
 t ::= & \quad x && \text{variable} \\
 & \quad | (\lambda x : E) t && \text{functional abstraction} \\
 & \quad | App([x : E]E, t, t) && \text{function application} \\
 & \quad | (\forall x : E) t && \text{universal quantification}
 \end{aligned}$$

Remark 2.1. We write $App([x : E]E, t, t)$ in order to keep track of the types involved in the application of the two terms, and it kept explicit in order to make applying structural induction over the expressions easier. This notation is discussed further in [26].

We say a *pre-context* is a syntactical expression of the form $x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$, where $x_1, \dots, x_n$ are pairwise syntactically different variables and $A_1, \dots, A_n$ are pre-type-expressions. Contexts are ranged over by capital greek letters. We define $Var(\Gamma)$ as the set of variables declared in Γ . We will not distinguish expressions which are equivalent up to renaming of variables (α -conversion), to do this we will be using *de Bruijn indices*. De Bruijn indices eliminate the necessity for explicit variable names by replacing them with natural numbers representing the exact lexical depth between a variable's localized occurrence and its binding context. We define a *pre-judgment* to be a syntactic expression of one of the following forms:

$$\begin{aligned}
 A \text{ type} & \quad A \text{ is a type} \\
 A = B & \quad A \text{ and } B \text{ are equal types} \\
 t : A & \quad t \text{ is an object of type } A \\
 t = s : A & \quad t \text{ and } s \text{ are equal objects of type } A
 \end{aligned}$$

We use the letter $\mathcal{J}$ to refer to pre-judgments. We define a *pre-sequent* as a syntactic expression of the following form:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \Gamma ok & \quad \Gamma \text{ is a context} \\
 \Gamma = \Delta & \quad \Gamma \text{ and } \Delta \text{ are equal contexts} \\
 \Gamma \vdash \mathcal{J} & \quad \text{the judgement } \mathcal{J} \text{ holds with respect to } \Gamma
 \end{aligned}$$

Finally, we define the set of *sequents*, i.e., valid pre-sequents, to be generated by the set of rules in A.2. Sequents are ranged over by capital italic letters. This set of rules is more extended than the original in order to make explicit rules for handling contexts

and to add more rules stating equality of types and objects. We can distinguish different kinds of rules for different purposes:

1. Context Rules: their purpose is to make contexts first-class citizens of CoC, unlike in GATs where they were defined outside the rule system. These includes: context formation rules and context equality rules
2. Structural Rules for Judgments: their purpose is to form and serve as equality rules for judgments.
3. Rules for Product Types: these rules include everything needed for working with products.
4. Rules for Propositions: finally, the machinery to work with the *Prop* universe, *Proof* and $\forall$.

2.2 Doctrines of Constructions

We leverage the concept of Context Categories introduced in the earlier chapter to serve as a basic structure for handling dependent types, and add more conditions so that it can handle products of families of types, universal quantification and properties universe, in order to develop a categorical structure that captures the interpretation of the Calculus of Constructions.

Although products might be added directly in the GAT structure, we enforce them to the base level as they are needed to the definition of universal quantification.

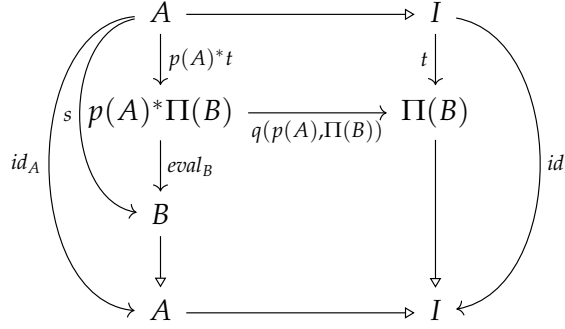
Definition 2.2. A *contextual category with products of families of types* is a category $\mathcal{C}$ together with two mappings Π and $eval$ defined over the collection of objects B of $\mathcal{C}$ with $level(B) \geq 2$, such that:

1. Whenever $I \triangleleft A \triangleleft B$, then $I \triangleleft \Pi(B)$ and $eval_B: p(A)^*\Pi(B) \rightarrow B$ is a morphism over A

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 p(A)^*\Pi(B) & \xrightarrow{eval_B} & B \\
 \searrow & & \swarrow \\
 p(p(A)^*\Pi(B)) & \xrightarrow{\Delta} & A
 \end{array}
 \quad \begin{array}{c} p(B) \end{array}$$

such that for all $s \in Sections(B)$ there is a unique section $t \in Sections(\Pi(B))$ with

$eval_B \circ p(A)^*t = s$. This unique section t is called $curry(s)$.



Remark 2.3. As any section t of $\Pi(B)$ gives a section $eval_B \circ p(A)^*t$ of B , there is a canonical 1-1-correspondence between $Sections(B)$ and $Sections(\Pi(B))$.

2. For any object J and any morphism $f: J \rightarrow I$, the following conditions are satisfied:

$$f^*(\Pi(B)) = \Pi(f^*B) \quad \text{and} \quad f^*(eval_B) = eval_{f^*B}.$$

It follows from the definition that substitution preserves functional abstraction or currying:

Lemma 2.4. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a contextual category with products of families of types. Let $I \triangleleft A \triangleleft B$ be objects and $f: J \rightarrow I$ a morphism in $\mathcal{C}$. If t is a section of B , then

$$f^*(curry(B)) = curry(f^*B).$$

Notice that in any contextual category with products of families of types, the following equations hold:

$$eval_B \circ p(A)^*curry(s) = s; \tag{\beta}$$

$$curry(eval_B \circ p(A)^*t) = t. \tag{\eta}$$

The first equation corresponds to the β -rule of typed λ -calculi and the second equation corresponds to the η -rule of typed λ -calculi. Contextual Categories with products correspond to λ -calculus with dependent types.

Definition 2.5. Let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}'$ be two contextual categories with products of families of types, we a contextual functor $F: \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}'$ preserves products of families of types if for $1 \triangleleft A \triangleleft B$ in $\mathcal{C}$,

$$F\Pi(B) = \Pi(FB) \quad \text{and} \quad F eval_B = eval_{FB}.$$

Now we add the type of propositions. To do it, we find objects in our category whose sections, i.e., its terms, correspond to objects.

Definition 2.6. Let $\mathcal{C}$ be a context category. An *enumeration of types* of $\mathcal{C}$ is an object T of $\mathcal{C}$ with $\text{level}(T) = 2$.

An enumeration of types T of $\mathcal{C}$ is called a *collection of types* of $\mathcal{C}$ if for all objects A and morphisms $f, g: A \rightarrow \text{parent}(T)$,

$$f^*T = g^*T \implies f = g.$$

It is the object $\text{parent}(T)$ that we are interested in.

And finally, by wrapping everything up and adding universal quantification we have the desired structure:

Definition 2.7. A *doctrine of constructions* is a contextual category with products of families of types together with a collection of types T such that for all $A, B \in \text{Ob } \mathcal{C}$ with $A \triangleleft B$ and $f: B \rightarrow \text{Prop}$, where $\text{Prop} = \text{parent}(T)$, there exists a necessarily unique morphism $g: A \rightarrow \text{Prop}$ also denoted by $\forall(f)$ such that

$$g^*T = \forall(f)^*T = \Pi(f^*T).$$

Definition 2.8. Let $\mathcal{C}, \mathcal{C}'$ be two doctrines of constructions. A *functor of doctrines of constructions* is a contextual functor $F: \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}'$ that preserves products of families of types such that if T and T' are the selected collections of types of $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}'$ respectively, $FT = T'$, and for any $A \triangleleft B$ in $\mathcal{C}$, and $f: B \rightarrow \text{Prop}$, $F(\forall(f)) = \forall(F(f))$.

We consider the category **DoC** of doctrines of constructions and functors of doctrines of constructions.

Now we see that doctrines of constructions correspond to models of Calculus of Constructions.

2.3 Interpretation of Calculus of Constructions

In this section, we define the interpretation of Calculus of Constructions in arbitrary doctrines of constructions.

To do this, fixed one doctrine of constructions, an *interpretation function* $\mathcal{M}$ should be a mapping such that:

1. for every pre-context Γ of length n , if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]$ is defined, then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]$ is an object of *level* n ;
2. for every pre-context of length n and type expression A , if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ is defined then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ is an object of *level* $n + 1$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma] \triangleleft \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$;
3. for every pre-context Γ of length n and object expression t , if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$ is defined then it is a morphism $s: \mathcal{M}[\Gamma] \rightarrow A$ where A is an object of *level* $n + 1$ such that

$$\mathcal{M}[\Gamma] \triangleleft A \quad \text{and} \quad p(A) \circ s = \text{id}_{\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]}.$$

We want to build this function by induction. We need an auxiliary definition:

Definition 2.9. By structural induction of expressions we define a function $depth$ mapping pre-well-formed expressions and pre-contexts to ω :

$$depth[x] = 1$$

$$depth[Prop] = 1$$

$$depth[Proof(A)] = depth[A] + 1$$

$$depth[(\Pi x : A)B] = depth[A] + depth[B] + 1$$

$$depth[(\lambda x : A)t] = depth[A] + depth[t] + 1$$

$$depth[(\forall x : A)t] = depth[A] + depth[t] + 1$$

$$depth[App([x : A]B, t, s)] = depth[A] + depth[B] + depth[t] + depth[s] + 1$$

$$\text{For } \Gamma \equiv x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n, \quad depth[\Gamma] = \sum_{i=1}^n depth[A_i].$$

We define $\mathcal{M}$ by induction on the level of its arguments, where

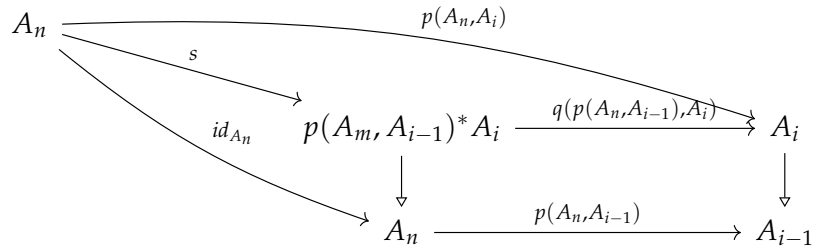
$$level[\Gamma] = depth[\Gamma],$$

$$level[\Gamma; A] = depth[\Gamma] + depth[A],$$

$$level[\Gamma; t] = depth[\Gamma] + depth[t]$$

by the following clauses:

1. $\mathcal{M}[] = 1$;
2. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x : A] = \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$;
3. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, (\Pi x : A)B] = \Pi(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x : A; B])$ if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x : A; B]$ is defined;
4. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, Prop] = p(\mathcal{M}, 1)^* Prop$ if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]$ is defined;
5. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; Proof(p)] = \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; p]^* p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma], 1)^* T$ if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; p]$ is defined and a section of $p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma], 1)^* Prop$;
6. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x] = s$ provided that $\Gamma \equiv x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$ and $x_i \equiv x$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]$ is defined and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma] = A_n \triangleright \dots \triangleright A_1 \triangleright A_0 \triangleright 1$ and s as follows



or, in other terms, $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; x_i] = p(A_n, A_i)^* \Delta(A_i)$ where $\Delta(A_i)$ is the unique arrow $m: A_i \rightarrow p(A_i)^* A_i$ such that

$$p(p(A_i)^* A_i) \circ m = q(p(A_i), A_i) \circ m = id_{A_i};$$

7. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; (\lambda x: A) t] = \text{curry}(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; t])$ if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; t]$ is defined. By induction hypothesis we have that $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma] \triangleleft \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A] \triangleleft \text{cod}(\mathcal{M}[\gamma, x: A; t])$ and s is a section of $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; t]$ and therefore we have:

$$\text{eval}_{\text{cod}(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; t])} \circ p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A])^* \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; (\lambda x: A) t] = \mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; t];$$

8. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; \text{App}([x: A] B), t, s] = \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; s]^*(\text{eval}_{\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; B]} \circ p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A])^* \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t])$ provided that $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$, $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; s]$, $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; B]$ are defined, and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; s]$ is a section of $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$ is a section of $\Pi(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; B])$;
9. $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; (\forall x: A) p] = s$ if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; p]$ is a section of $p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A], 1)^* \text{Prop}$ and s is the unique section of $p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma], 1)$ such that

$$\begin{aligned} \forall (q(p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A], 1), \text{Prop}) \circ \mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; p]) = \\ q(p(\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A], 1), \text{Prop}) \circ \mathcal{M}[\Gamma, x: A; p] \end{aligned}$$

Theorem 2.10 (Correctness Theorem). *For any doctrine of constructions, the following correctness conditions for $\mathcal{M}$ are satisfied:*

1. if $\Gamma \text{ ok}$ is derivable, then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]$ is defined;
2. if $\Gamma \vdash A$ type is derivable, then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ is defined;
3. if $\Gamma \vdash t: A$ is derivable, then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$ are both defined and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$ is a section of $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$;
4. if $\Gamma = \Delta$ is derivable, then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Delta]$ are defined and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma] = \mathcal{M}[\Delta]$;
5. if $\Gamma \vdash A = B$ is derivable, then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; B]$ are both defined and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A] = \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; B]$;

6. if $\Gamma \vdash t = s \in A$ is derivable, then $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$, $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; s]$ are defined, both $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; s]$ are sections of $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t] = \mathcal{M}[\Gamma; s]$.

Hence, doctrines of constructions are models of Calculus of Constructions.

2.4 The Term Model of Calculus of Constructions

In this section, we construct a doctrine of constructions $\mathcal{C}_I$ as a *term model* of calculus of constructions such that the interpretation in this model interprets provably well-defined contexts, types and objects, and identifies only those contexts, types or objects which are provably equal up to renaming of the variables bound in contexts.

In more technical terms, this means that for the interpretation function $\mathcal{M}$ assigning meaning to calculus of constructions in the doctrine of constructions $\mathcal{C}_I$, the following requirements must be fulfilled:

1. for all pre-contexts Γ and Δ , if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma] = \mathcal{M}[\Delta]$, then $\Gamma = \Delta$ is derivable;
2. for all pre-contexts Γ and Δ and pre-type-expressions A and B , if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A] = \mathcal{M}[\Delta; B]$, then $\Gamma = \Delta$ and $\Gamma \vdash A = B$ are derivable;
3. for all pre-contexts Γ, Δ , pre-type-expressions A, B and pre-object-expressions t, s , if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t] = \mathcal{M}[\Delta; s]$ is a section of $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A] = [\Delta; B]$, then $\Gamma = \Delta$, $\Gamma \vdash A = B$ and $\Gamma \vdash t = s : A$ are derivable.

In order to be able to identify contexts up to α -conversion, we consider a fixed numerable set of variables: $v_1, \dots, v_n, \dots$. We say that a context $\Gamma = x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n$ is in *α -normal form* iff $x_i = v_i$ for all $1 \leq i \leq n$. Moreover, we say that a pre-context Γ is *admissible* iff it is in α -normal form and $\vdash \Gamma \text{ ok}$.

Now we define $\mathcal{C}_I$: The objects of $\mathcal{C}_I$ are the admissible contexts modulo provable equivalence, i.e., that we will consider two contexts Γ and Δ equal iff $\Gamma = \Delta$ is derivable. By induction over the structure of derivations, one can see that $\Gamma = \Delta$ implies that Γ and Δ have the same length as pre-contexts, so we can define the *level* of an object of $\mathcal{C}_I$ as the length of any of its representatives. We will write $[\Gamma]$ to represent the class containing Γ . If $\Gamma = v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n$ is an admissible context, then we define

$$\text{parent}[\Gamma] = [v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_{n-1} : A_{n-1}],$$

that is well defined according to rule CREFL.

If $\Gamma = v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n$ and $\Delta = v_1 : B_1, \dots, v_m : B_m$ are admissible contexts, a morphism from $[\Gamma]$ to $[\Delta]$ is given by a m -tuple $\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle$ of terms such that for i , $1 \leq i \leq m$,

$$\Gamma \vdash t_i : B_i[v_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, v_{i-1} \leftarrow t_{i-1}]$$

is derivable, if $\langle s_1, \dots, s_m \rangle$ is another m -tuple such that for $i, 1 \leq i \leq m$

$$\Gamma \vdash s_i : B_i[v_1 \leftarrow s_1, \dots, v_{i-1} \leftarrow s_{i-1}]$$

is derivable, then $\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle$ and $\langle s_1, \dots, s_m \rangle$ are considered equal iff for $i, 1 \leq i \leq m$

$$\Gamma \vdash t_i = s_i : B_i[v_1 \leftarrow s_1, \dots, v_{i-1} \leftarrow s_{i-1}]$$

is derivable, by the rule CREFL the definition is independent from the choice of representatives. We write $[\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle] : [\Gamma] \rightarrow [\Delta]$ for the class of m -tuples equatable to $\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle$. If we consider $\Theta = v_1 : C_1, \dots, v_k : C_k$ is another admissible context and $[\langle s_1, \dots, s_k \rangle] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Theta]$, then the composition of $[\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle]$ with $[\langle s_1, \dots, s_k \rangle]$ is defined as

$$[\langle s_1, \dots, s_k \rangle] \circ [\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle] = [\langle s_1[v_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, v_m \leftarrow t_m], \dots, s_k[v_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, v_m \leftarrow t_m] \rangle].$$

If $\Gamma = v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n$ is an admissible context with $n \geq 1$ then the *canonical projection* map $p([\Gamma]) : [\Gamma] \rightarrow \text{parent}[\Gamma]$ is represented by the tuple $\langle v_1, \dots, v_{n-1} \rangle$. Let $\Gamma = v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n$ and $\Delta = v_1 : B_1, \dots, v_m : B_m$ admissible contexts, $t = [\langle t_1, \dots, t_m \rangle]$ a morphism from $[\Gamma]$ to $[\Delta]$ and C a pre-well-formed type expression with $\Delta \vdash C$ type, i.e., $\Delta, v_{m+1} : C$ is an admissible context, then

$$t^*[\Delta, v_{m+1} : C] = [\Delta, v_{m+1} : C[v_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, v_m \leftarrow t_m]]$$

$$q([t], [\Delta, v_{m+1} : C]) = [\langle t_1, \dots, t_m, v_{m+1} \rangle] : t^*[\Delta, v_{m+1} : C] \rightarrow [\Delta, v_{m+1} : C].$$

If $\Gamma = v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n, v_{n+1} : B, v_{n+2} : C$ is an admissible context we define

$$\Pi([\Gamma]) = [\Gamma, v_{n+1} : (\Pi v_{n+1} : B)C]$$

$$\text{eval}_{[\Gamma]} = [\langle v_1, \dots, v_n, v_{n+1}, \text{App}([v_{n+1} : B]C, v_{n+2}, v_{n+1}) \rangle],$$

which can be seen to be a morphism from $[\Gamma, v_{n+1} : B, v_{n+2} : (\Pi v_{n+1} B)C]$ to $[\Gamma]$ over the object $[v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n]$. The object Prop of C_I is defined as $[v_1 : \text{Prop}]$ and the object T of C_I is defined as the object $[v_1 : \text{Prop}, v_2 : \text{Proof}(v_1)]$. If $\Gamma = v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n, v_{n+1} : B$ and $[\langle p \rangle]$ is a morphism from $[\Gamma]$ to $[v_1 : \text{Prop}]$ then we define

$$\forall([p]) = [\langle (\forall v_{n+1} : B)p \rangle] : [v_1 : A_1, \dots, v_n : A_n] \rightarrow [v_1 : \text{Prop}].$$

It is proven in [26] that C_I is in fact a doctrine of constructions. Also, it is immediate to see that C_I does not interpret or identify more objects or terms that those that are provably defined as equal.

Theorem 2.11 (Completeness Theorem). *Let $\mathcal{M}$ be the interpretation of calculus of construction in C_I . Then*

1. *if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma]$ is defined then Γ ok is derivable;*

2. if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A]$ is defined then $\Gamma \vdash A$ type is derivable;
3. if $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t]$ is defined then $\Gamma \vdash t : A$ is derivable for some pre-type-expression A ;
4. if $\Gamma \equiv x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n, \Delta \equiv y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A] = \mathcal{M}[\Delta; B]$, then $n = m$ and

$$\begin{aligned} v_1 : A_1[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n], \dots, v_n : A_n[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n] = \\ = v_1 : B_1[y_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow v_m], \dots, v_m : B_m[y_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow v_m] \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} v_1 : A_1[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n], \dots, v_n : A_n[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n] \\ \vdash A[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n] = B[y_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow v_m] \end{aligned}$$

are derivable;

5. if $\Gamma \equiv x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n, \Delta \equiv y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$ and $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; t] = \mathcal{M}[\Delta; s]$, then $n = m$ and

$$\begin{aligned} v_1 : A_1[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n], \dots, v_n : A_n[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n] = \\ = v_1 : B_1[y_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow v_m], \dots, v_m : B_m[y_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow v_m] \end{aligned}$$

is derivable, and, for some pre-type-expression A ,

$$\begin{aligned} v_1 : A_1[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n], \dots, v_n : A_n[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n] \\ \vdash t[x_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow v_n] = s[y_1 \leftarrow v_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow v_m] : A \end{aligned}$$

is derivable.

Proof. A proof is included in [26]. □

It can be also shown that $\mathcal{C}_I$ is the initial object of the category of doctrines of constructions and structure preserving functors, named **DoC** [26]. Hence the term model satisfies the properties of soundness, completeness and initiality that we wanted.

2.5 Extending Calculus of Constructions and its Interpretation

In this section we show how to add symbols to Calculus of Constructions, the same thing that we could do in GATs. We need to understand the current CoC as just as a minimal starting point, same as the empty theory for GATs. Inspired by the constructions for Categories with Families presented in [4], we inductively define the concept of signature Σ (corresponding to theory when talking about GATs), CoC extended by Σ , the corresponding category **DoC** $_{\Sigma}$ and interpretation functions $\mathcal{M}^{\Sigma}$.

As a starting case, we consider the empty signature $\Sigma = \emptyset$, together with $\text{CoC}_\emptyset$ representing the current syntax of Calculus of Constructions. The category $\mathbf{DoC}_\emptyset$ is exactly $\mathbf{DoC}$, and the notion of interpretation morphism stays the same.

Now, for the inductive step, assume we have defined Σ as a valid signature, and the associated syntax CoC_Σ , category $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ and interpretation function $\mathcal{M}^\Sigma$. Then

- **Adding a sort symbol:** Let Γ be a context in CoC_Σ . We can extend Σ with a sort symbol S relative to Γ , to obtain the signature $\Sigma' = (\Sigma, (\Gamma, S))$. Then, we extend CoC_Σ to obtain $\text{CoC}_{\Sigma'}$ by adding a production of pre-type-expressions $E ::= S$ and the inference rule $\Gamma \vdash S$. The category $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$ has as objects pairs $(\mathcal{C}, S_{\mathcal{C}})$, where $\mathcal{C}$ is an object of $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ and $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^\Sigma[\Gamma] \triangleleft S_{\mathcal{C}}$; and morphisms from $(\mathcal{C}, S_{\mathcal{C}})$ to $(\mathcal{D}, S_{\mathcal{D}})$ are morphisms F from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{D}$ in $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ such that $FS_{\mathcal{C}} = S_{\mathcal{D}}$. Finally, we define $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\Sigma'}$, for each object $\mathcal{C}$ of $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$, by adding $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\Sigma'}[\Gamma; S] = S_{\mathcal{C}}$.
- **Adding an operator symbol:** Let Γ be a context and A be a type under Γ of CoC_Σ , we can extend Σ with a new operator symbol f relative to Γ and A obtaining $\Sigma' = (\Sigma, (\Gamma, A, f))$. Then, we extend CoC_Σ to obtain $\text{CoC}_{\Sigma'}$ by adding a production of pre-object-expressions $t ::= f$ and the inference rule $\Gamma \vdash f : A$. The category $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$ has as objects pairs $(\mathcal{C}, f_{\mathcal{C}})$, where $\mathcal{C}$ is an object of $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ and $f_{\mathcal{C}}$ is a section of $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^\Sigma[\Gamma, x : A]$; and morphisms from $(\mathcal{C}, f_{\mathcal{C}})$ to $(\mathcal{D}, f_{\mathcal{D}})$ are morphisms F from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{D}$ in $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ such that $Ff_{\mathcal{C}} = f_{\mathcal{D}}$. Finally, we define $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\Sigma'}$, for each object $\mathcal{C}$ of $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$, by adding $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^{\Sigma'}[\Gamma; f] = f_{\mathcal{C}}$.
- **Adding an equality of types:** Let Γ be a context, A, A' types under Γ of CoC_Σ , we can extend Σ with a new equation $A = A'$ relative to Γ , to obtain $\Sigma' = (\Sigma, (\Gamma, A, A'))$. Then, we extend CoC_Σ to obtain $\text{CoC}_{\Sigma'}$ by adding the inference rule $\Gamma \vdash A = A'$. The category $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$ is a full subcategory of $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ containing the objects $\mathcal{C}$ of $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ such that $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^\Sigma[\Gamma; A] = \mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^\Sigma[\Gamma; A']$. $\mathcal{M}^{\Sigma'}$ is the restriction of $\mathcal{M}^\Sigma$ to the objects of $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$.
- **Adding an equality of terms:** Let Γ be a context, A a type under Γ , and a, a' terms of type A under Γ of CoC_Σ . We can extend Σ with a new equation $a = a'$ relative to Γ and A , to obtain $\Sigma' = (\Sigma, (\Gamma, A, a, a'))$. Then, we extend CoC_Σ to obtain $\text{CoC}_{\Sigma'}$ by adding the inference rule $\Gamma \vdash a = a' : A$. The category $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$ is a full subcategory of $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ containing the objects $\mathcal{C}$ of $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ such that $\mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^\Sigma[\Gamma; a] = \mathcal{M}_{\mathcal{C}}^\Sigma[\Gamma; a']$. $\mathcal{M}^{\Sigma'}$ is the restriction of $\mathcal{M}^\Sigma$ to the objects of $\mathbf{DoC}_{\Sigma'}$.

Under this construction, we can consider $\mathcal{C}_\Sigma$ to be the exact same construction as $\mathcal{C}_I$, but with CoC_Σ instead of $\text{CoC}_\emptyset$. Constructing the quotiented subcategory $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ introduces profound complexities, primarily because adding contextual equality rules makes object identity within the category undecidable. While the syntactic extension

and interpretations map cleanly, rigorously proving the initiality of this specific quotiented term model requires verifying coherence conditions that fall outside the scope of this thesis. We leave the formal proof of initiality for $\mathbf{DoC}_\Sigma$ as an open challenge for future work.

2.6 Expansion Algorithm for CoC

First, we want to redefine our problem from the previous definition for GATs to our new syntax, and rephrase it to similar categorical terms. Then we propose an extended version of the Expansion Algorithm.

The problem now can be formalized as follows: Given a valid signature of Calculus of Constructions Σ and a derivable sequent $\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}$ in CoC_Σ , we want to find a pre-object-expression t such that $\Gamma \vdash t : A$ is a derivable sequent in CoC_Σ .

We can consider this from the point of view of the category $\mathcal{C}_\Sigma$ introduced in the previous section. This means that our problem is equivalent to finding a section s of $\mathcal{M}[\Gamma; A] = [\Gamma, v_{n+1} : A]$ in $\mathcal{C}_\Sigma$, assuming Γ is a context of length n in normal form.

Moreover, we want to use the reduction of our search space we did on the previous case by considering the category over a base object. To do it we need the following result:

Definition 2.12. Given a doctrine of constructions $\mathcal{C}$, and an arbitrary object A of $\mathcal{C}$. The *relativization* of $\mathcal{C}$ to A , noted as $\mathcal{C}_A$, is defined as follows:

1. $\mathcal{C}_A$ is a category whose objects are the collection of objects B over A in $\mathcal{C}$, i.e. objects B in $\mathcal{C}$ such that $A \leq B$;
2. for two objects B, C in $\mathcal{C}_A$, a morphism from B to C over A , i.e., a morphism in $\mathcal{C}_A$, is a morphism $f : B \rightarrow C$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that $p(C, A) \circ f = p(B, A)$, composition of morphisms is inherited from $\mathcal{C}$;
3. $\text{parent}_A(B) = \text{parent}(B)$ for $B > A$ and $\text{parent}_A(A) = \text{parent}(A)$;
4. for objects $B > A$, we define $p_A(B) = p(B) : B \rightarrow \text{parent}_A(B)$;
5. for B, C, D objects of $\mathcal{C}$ with $\text{parent}_A(D) = C$ and morphism $f : B \rightarrow C$ in $\mathcal{C}_A$ we define

$$f^{*A}D = f^*D \quad \text{and} \quad q_A(f, D) = q(f, D);$$

6. for B in $\mathcal{C}$ with $\text{level}_A(B) \geq 2$,

$$\Pi_A(B) = \Pi(B) \quad \text{and} \quad \text{eval}_B^A = \text{eval}_B;$$

7. if T is the collection of types of $\mathcal{C}$, then

$$T_A = p(A)^*T$$

is the collection of types of $\mathcal{C}_A$.

Theorem 2.13. *The relativization $\mathcal{C}_A$ of a doctrine of constructions $\mathcal{C}$ to an object A is a doctrine of constructions.*

Proof. We already know from the first chapter that $\mathcal{C}_A$ is a contextual category. Let us check if it is also a doctrine of constructions with these extra structure we introduce.

It is clear that $\mathcal{C}_A$ is a contextual category with products of families of types as for any object B of $\mathcal{C}_A$ with $\text{level}_A(B) \geq 2$, we have that $\text{level}(B) \geq 2$ and as $\mathcal{C}$ is a contextual category with products of families of types, $\Pi_A(B) = \Pi(B)$ is defined and $\text{parent}(\Pi(B)) = \text{parent}^2(B)$, and hence $\Pi_A(B) \triangleright A$, hence it is well defined. Then for $\text{eval}_B^A = \text{eval}_B$: $p(\text{parent}(B))^*\Pi(B) \rightarrow B$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{C}_A$ as by definition the following diagram commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 p(\text{parent}(B))^*\Pi(B) & \xrightarrow{\text{eval}_B^A = \text{eval}_B} & B \\
 & \searrow & \swarrow \\
 & \text{parent}(B) & \\
 & \downarrow & \\
 & A &
 \end{array}$$

Now, if s is a section of B in $\mathcal{C}_A$, it is a section of B in $\mathcal{C}$. Hence there exists a unique section t of $\Pi(B)$ in $\mathcal{C}$ such that $\text{eval}_B \circ p(A)^*t = s$, as $p(\Pi(B)) \circ t = \text{id}_{\text{parent}(\Pi(B))}$, it is clear that t is a section of $\Pi_A(B)$ in $\mathcal{C}_A$. Now if J is an object and $f: J \rightarrow \text{parent}^2(B)$ is a morphism in $\mathcal{C}_A$, in particular, they belong to $\mathcal{C}$. So we have that $\Pi(f^*B) = f^*\Pi(B)$ and $\text{eval}_{f^*B} = f^*\text{eval}_B$, but by definition of Π_A and eval_A we have that $\Pi_A(f^*B) = f^*\Pi_A(B)$ and $\text{eval}_{f^*B}^A = f^*\text{eval}_B^A$. With this we conclude that $\mathcal{C}_A$ is a contextual category with products of families of types.

Now we see that $T_A = p(A)^*T$ is indeed a collection of types of $\mathcal{C}_A$. Consider then two morphisms $f, g: J \rightarrow \text{parent}(T_A)$, for some object A in $\mathcal{C}_A$, such that $f^*T_A = g^*T_A$. We want to see that indeed $f = g$. We have that

$$f^*(q(p(A), \text{Prop})^*T) = g^*(q(p(A), \text{Prop})^*T)$$

and we derive that

$$(q(p(A), \text{Prop}) \circ f)^*T = (q(p(A), \text{Prop}) \circ g)^*T.$$

As T is a collection of types in $\mathcal{C}$,

$$q(p(A), \text{Prop}) \circ f = q(p(A), \text{Prop}) \circ g.$$

And finally $f = g$ as both make the following pullback diagram commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 J & & & & \\
 \searrow^{f=g} & & \xrightarrow{q(p(A), Prop) \circ f} & & \\
 & Prop_A & \xrightarrow{q(p(A), Prop)} & Prop & \\
 \searrow & \downarrow & & \downarrow & \\
 & A & \xrightarrow{\quad} & 1 &
 \end{array}$$

Finally, let B, C be objects of $\mathcal{C}_A$ and $f: C \rightarrow Prop_A$ a morphism over A . Then we want to see that there exists a necessarily unique morphism $g: B \rightarrow Prop_A$ such that $g^*T_A = \Pi_A(f^*T_A)$. As $\mathcal{C}$ holds this property, we consider $q(p(A), Prop) \circ f: C \rightarrow Prop$, hence there exists a necessarily unique $g': B \rightarrow Prop$ such that $g'^*T = \Pi((q(p(A), Prop) \circ f)^*T) = \Pi(f^*T_A)$, and by considering g the unique function that makes the following pullback diagram commute:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 B & & & & \\
 \searrow^g & & \xrightarrow{g'} & & \\
 & Prop_A & \xrightarrow{q(p(A), Prop)} & Prop & \\
 \searrow & \downarrow & & \downarrow & \\
 & A & \xrightarrow{\quad} & 1 &
 \end{array}$$

We then have that $g' = q(p(A), Prop) \circ g$, hence:

$$\begin{aligned}
 g^*T_A &= g^*(q(p(A), Prop)^*T) \\
 &= (q(p(A), Prop) \circ g)^*T \\
 &= g'^*T \\
 &= \Pi((q(p(A), Prop) \circ f)^*T) \\
 &= \Pi(f^*(q(p(A), Prop)^*T)) = \Pi_A(f^*T_A).
 \end{aligned}$$

This concludes the proof, as g is a morphism over A . □

With this result, and with the notation of Γ subscript introduced in the second chapter, we reduce our problem to finding a section of $[\Gamma, x: A]$ in $\mathcal{C}_{\Sigma, \Gamma}$, the relativization of $\mathcal{C}_\Sigma$ to Γ .

Now we extend the expansion algorithm from the previous chapter. We reintroduce the rules in order to match the syntax we are using for Calculus of Constructions. First, consider G to be a finite subcategory of $\mathcal{C}_{\Sigma, \Gamma}$ containing $[\Gamma]$, $[\Gamma, p: Prop]$, $\Gamma, x: A$ and their projections. Now we define the expansion rules. If Δ is a context, then:

E1 For each sort symbol in the signature Σ , with an introductory rule $\Omega \vdash \text{Type}$,

where $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$, $\Omega = z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w$, if G_n contains sections

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_1 : C_1] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\ &\vdots \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]], \end{aligned}$$

then we add $[\Delta, y : A[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]]$ to G_{n+1} .

E2 If $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$, then we add the sections

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, x_i \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, x : A_i] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, y_j \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, y : B_j] \end{aligned}$$

for each $1 \leq i \leq n$ and each $1 \leq j \leq m$.

E3 For each sort symbol in the signature Σ , with an introductory rule $\Omega \vdash F : A$, where $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$, $\Omega = z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w$ if the following sections exist in G_n :

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_1 : C_1] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\ &\vdots \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] &\rightarrow [\Delta, z_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]], \end{aligned}$$

then we add the section

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, F[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w] \rangle_\Gamma] : \\ [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, z : A[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]]. \end{aligned}$$

E4 If $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m$, for every morphism

$$[\langle t_1, \dots, t_{m-1} \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w] \rightarrow [\Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_{m-1} : B_{m-1}],$$

we construct the corresponding pullback to G_{n+1} :

$$\begin{array}{ccc} [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w, & \xrightarrow{[\langle t_1, \dots, t_{m-1}, y_m \rangle_\Gamma]} & [\Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m] \\ y_m : B_m[t_1 \leftarrow y_1, \dots, t_{m-1} \leftarrow y_{m-1}]] & & \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ [\Gamma, z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w] & \xrightarrow{[\langle t_1, \dots, t_{m-1} \rangle_\Gamma]} & [\Gamma, y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_{m-1} : B_{m-1}] \end{array}$$

E5 If $\Delta = \Gamma, v_1 : B_1, \dots, v_m : B_m, v_{m+1} : C, v_{n+2} : D$ we add

$$\Pi([\Delta]) = [\Gamma, v_1 : B_1, \dots, v_m : B_m, v_{m+1} : (\Pi v_{m+1} : C)D]$$

$$eval_{[\Delta]} = [\langle v_1, \dots, v_{m+1}, App([v_{m+1}: C]D, v_{m+2}, v_{m+1}) \rangle_{\Gamma}].$$

a morphism from $[\Gamma, v_1: A_1, \dots, v_m: B_m, v_{n+1}: C, v_{n+2}: (\Pi v_{n+1}: B)C]$ to $[\Delta]$.

E6 If $\Delta = \Gamma, v_1: B_1, \dots, v_m: B_m, v_{m+1}: C$, for any morphism

$$[\langle v_1, \dots, v_m, v_{m+1}, p \rangle_{\Gamma}]: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, x: Prop]$$

we add

$$\begin{aligned} & [\langle v_1, \dots, v_m, (\forall: v_{m+1}C)p \rangle_{\Gamma}]: \\ & [\Gamma, v_1: B_1, \dots, v_m: B_m] \rightarrow [\Gamma, v_1: B_1, \dots, v_m: B_m, x: Prop] \\ & [\Delta, x: Proof(p)]. \end{aligned}$$

E7 If $\Delta = \Gamma, v_1: B_1, \dots, v_m: B_m$, for every pair of sections $[\langle v_1, \dots, v_m, t \rangle_{\Gamma}]$ and $[\langle v_1, \dots, v_m, s \rangle_{\Gamma}]$ of $[\Delta, f: (\Pi x: A)B]$ and $[\Delta, x: A]$ respectively, we add

$$[\langle v_1, \dots, v_m, App([x: A]B, t, s) \rangle_{\Gamma}]: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, y: B[x \leftarrow s]].$$

After each expansion, we complete the category in the following way: for every product object, i.e., for each object $[\Delta]$ with Δ of the form $\Omega, f: (\Pi x: A)B$, and every section $s = \langle x, a \rangle_{\Omega}$ of $[\Omega, x: A, y: B]$ we add $curry(s) = \langle (\lambda x: A)a \rangle_{\Omega}$ as a section of $[\Delta]$. Also, we add the composition of morphisms to G_{n+1} in order to complete it as a subcategory of $\mathcal{C}_{\Sigma, \Gamma}$. As in the case of GATs, when adding a morphism we are implicitly adding its endpoints, and by adding an object we are adding its projection.

Now we prove the exhaustivity theorem. In order to do it we will have to prove some previous lemmas.

First, we introduce inversion (or generation) lemmas: given a derivable sequent, they characterize the syntactic form of its principal expression. The proof method is simultaneous structural induction on derivation height, and is detailed in Appendix B.

Lemma 2.14. *Given a derivable sequent of the form $\Gamma \vdash A$ type there are four possible cases:*

1. *A is equal to Prop;*
2. *A is equal to Proof(p) for some pre-object-expression p and $\Gamma \vdash p: Prop$ is derivable;*
3. *A is equal to $(\Pi x: B)C$ for pre-type-expressions B, C and a variable x, such that $\Gamma, x: B \vdash C$ type is a derivable sequent;*
4. *there exists a sort symbol S in Σ with an introductory rule*

$$y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m \vdash S \text{ type}$$

and sequents

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma \vdash t_1 &: B_1 \\ \Gamma \vdash t_2 &: B_2[y_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\ &\vdots \\ \Gamma \vdash t_m &: B_m[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_{m-1} \leftarrow t_{m-1}] \end{aligned}$$

such that A is equal to $S[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m]$.

Lemma 2.15. *Given a derivable sequent of the form $\Gamma \vdash t : A$ there are five possible cases:*

1. *there exists a variable x in $\text{Var}(\Gamma)$, such that t equals x ;*
2. *t is equal to $(\lambda x : B)s$ and A is equal to $(\Pi x : B)C$ for some pre-type-expressions B, C , a pre-object-expression s and variable x ;*
3. *t is equal to $\text{App}([x : B]C, s, r)$ and A is equal to $C[x \leftarrow r]$ for some pre-type-expressions B, C , pre-object-expressions s, r and variable x ;*
4. *t is equal to $(\forall x : B)s$ and A is equal to Prop for some pre-type-expression B , pre-object-expression s and variable x ;*
5. *there exist an operator symbol F in Σ with an introductory rule*

$$y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m \vdash F : B$$

and sequents

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma \vdash t_1 &: B_1 \\ \Gamma \vdash t_2 &: B_2[y_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\ &\vdots \\ \Gamma \vdash t_m &: B_m[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_{m-1} \leftarrow t_{m-1}] \end{aligned}$$

such that t is equal to $F[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m]$.

Now we expand the concept of *depth* to this new syntax:

Definition 2.16. By structural induction of expressions we define a function *depth* mapping pre-well-formed expressions and pre-contexts to ω :

1. if x is a variable, then $\text{depth}[x] = 1$;
2. $\text{depth}[\text{Prop}] = 1$;
3. if A is a pre-type-expression, then $\text{depth}[\text{Proof}(A)] = \text{depth}[A] + 1$;

4. if x is a variable, A and B are pre-type-expressions, and t and s are pre-type-expressions, then

$$\begin{aligned} \text{depth}[(\Pi x: A)B] &= \text{depth}[A] + \text{depth}[B] + 1 \\ \text{depth}[(\lambda x: A)t] &= \text{depth}[A] + \text{depth}[t] + 1 \\ \text{depth}[(\forall x: A)t] &= \text{depth}[A] + \text{depth}[t] + 1 \\ \text{depth}[\text{App}[x: A]B, t, s] &= \text{depth}[A] + \text{depth}[B] + \text{depth}[t] + \text{depth}[s] + 1; \end{aligned}$$

5. if S is a sort symbol from Σ with an introductory rule

$$z_1: C_1, \dots, z_w: C_w \vdash S \text{ type},$$

and $t_1, \dots, t_w$ are pre-term-expressions, then

$$\text{depth}[S[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]] = 1 + \sum_{i=1}^w \text{depth}[t_i];$$

6. if F is an operator symbol from Σ with an introductory rule

$$z_1: C_1, \dots, z_w: C_w \vdash F: A,$$

and $t_1, \dots, t_w$ are pre-term-expressions, then

$$\text{depth}[F[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]] = 1 + \sum_{i=1}^w \text{depth}[t_i].$$

We use it to prove the following lemma:

Lemma 2.17. *Every object and every section in $C_{\Sigma, \Gamma}$ are constructible by expansion.*

Proof. We perform this proof by induction over the *degree* of the objects and sections, where

1. if Δ is a context over Γ , then

$$\text{degree}[\Delta] = \text{depth}[\Delta] - \text{depth}[\Gamma];$$

2. if $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m$ is a context and $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma]$ is a section of $[\Delta, x: A]$, then

$$\text{degree}[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma] = \text{degree}[\Delta] + \text{depth}[t].$$

Consider then a context $\Delta = \Gamma, y_1: B_1, \dots, y_m: B_m$. We want to see that $[\Delta]$ is constructible by expansion. If $\text{degree}[\Delta] = 0$, then it is the case $\Delta = \Gamma$, and hence it is constructible by expansion. Consider now the case $\text{degree}[\Delta] > 0$. As the sequent $\Delta \text{ ok}$ is derivable, by the rule CONT-INTRO, we have that $\Delta' \vdash B_m \text{ type}$ is derivable, where $\Delta' = \Gamma, y_1: B_1, \dots, y_{m-1}: B_{m-1}$. By Lemma 2.14, we have to consider four cases:

1. We have that $B_m = Prop$. By induction hypothesis, $[\Delta']$ is constructible by expansion, also we have that $[\Gamma]$ and $[\Gamma, p: Prop]$ are constructible by expansion. Then by applying the rule E4 on the object $[\Gamma, p: Prop]$ and the projection morphism of $[\Delta']$ on $[\Gamma]$, we have that the following pullback diagram is constructible by expansion:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} [\Delta', x: Prop] & \xrightarrow{\langle x \rangle_\Gamma} & [\Gamma, x: Prop] \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ [\Delta'] & \longrightarrow & [\Gamma] \end{array}$$

and $[\Delta', x: Prop] = [\Delta]$ as they only differ by the naming of the bound variables.

2. We have that $B_m = Proof(p)$ for some pre-type-expression p . By rule PROP-TYPE, we have that $\Delta' \vdash p: Prop$. By induction hypothesis, $[\Delta', x: Prop]$ and the section $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_{m-1}, p \rangle_\Gamma]: [\Delta'] \rightarrow [\Delta', x: Prop]$ are constructible by expansion. Then, by applying expansion rule E6, we have that $[\Delta', x: Proof(p)]$ is constructible by expansion, and so it is $[\Delta] = [\Delta', x: Proof(p)]$ as they differ only by the naming of the bound variables.

3. We have that $B_m = (\Pi x: A)B$ for pre-type-expressions A, B and a variable x . By induction hypothesis,

$$[\Delta'] \longleftarrow [\Delta', x: A] \longleftarrow [\Delta', x: A, y: B]$$

is constructible by expansion. By applying rule E5 to the object $[\Delta', x: A, y: B]$ we have that

$$\Pi([\Delta, x: A, y: B]) = [\Delta', x: (\Pi x: A)B]$$

is constructible by expansion. Then, so is $[\Delta] = [\Delta', x: (\Pi x: A)B]$ as they only differ on the naming of bound variables.

4. We have that there exists a sort symbol S in Σ with an introductory rule

$$z_1: C_1, \dots, z_w: C_w \vdash S \text{ type}$$

and sequents

$$\begin{array}{l} \Gamma \vdash t_1: C_1 \\ \Gamma \vdash t_2: C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\ \vdots \\ \Gamma \vdash t_w: C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}] \end{array}$$

such that B_m is equal to $S[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]$. By induction hypothesis, we

have that the following sections are constructible by expansion:

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_{m-1}, t_1 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] &\rightarrow [\Delta', z_1 : C_1] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_{m-1}, t_2 \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] &\rightarrow [\Delta', z_2 : C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\ &\vdots \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_{m-1}, t_w \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta'] &\rightarrow [\Delta', z_w : C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]]. \end{aligned}$$

So by applying the expansion rule E1 to $[\Delta']$, we have that

$$[\Delta', x : S[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]]$$

is constructible by expansion. Hence, so is $[\Delta] = [\Delta', x : S[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]]$ as they differ only in the naming of bound variables.

Now consider the section

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, x : A].$$

We want to see that it is constructible by expansion. We have that $\Delta \vdash t : A$ is derivable. By Lemma 2.15 we have the following cases:

1. Then, there is an i , $1 \leq i \leq m$, such that $t = y_i$. By induction hypothesis, $[\Delta]$ is constructible by expansion. By applying the expansion rule E2 to $[\Delta]$, we have that the section $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, y_i \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, x : B_i]$ is constructible by expansion, and so is $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma] = [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, y_i \rangle_\Gamma]$.
2. We have that $t = (\lambda x : B)s$ and $A = (\Pi x : B)C$ for pre-type-expressions B, C , a pre-object-expression s and a variable x . By induction hypothesis, we have that $[\Delta, x : A, y : B]$ and its section $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, x, s \rangle_\Gamma]$ are constructible by expansion. Then, by applying *curry* completion, we have that $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, (\lambda x : B)s \rangle_\Gamma] = [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma]$.
3. We have that $t = \text{App}([x : B]C, s, r)$ and $A = C[x \leftarrow r]$ for pre-type-expressions B, C , pre-object-expressions s, r and a variable x . By induction hypothesis, we have that $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, s \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, f : (\Pi x : B)C]$ and $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, r \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, x : B]$ are constructible by expansion. Then, by applying the expansion rule E7 we have that

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle_\Gamma] = [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, \text{App}([x : B]C, s, r) \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, y : B[x \leftarrow r]]$$

is constructible by expansion.

4. We have that $t = (\forall x : B)s$ and $A = \text{Prop}$ for pre-type-expression B , pre-object-expression s and variable x . By induction hypothesis, we have that

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, x, s \rangle_\Gamma] : [\Delta, x : B] \rightarrow [\Delta, x : B, p : \text{Prop}]$$

is constructible by expansion. And by applying the expansion rule E6 the morphism

$$[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, (\forall x: B) \rangle]_\Gamma: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, x: Prop]$$

is constructible by expansion.

5. Then, there exists an operator symbol F in Σ with an introductory rule

$$z_1: C_1, \dots, z_m: C_m \vdash F: B$$

and sequents

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma \vdash t_1: C_1 \\ \Gamma \vdash t_2: C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\ \vdots \\ \Gamma \vdash t_w: C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}] \end{aligned}$$

such that t is equal to $F[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]$. By induction hypothesis, we have that the following sections are constructible by expansion:

$$\begin{aligned} [\langle y_1, \dots, y_{m-1}, t_1 \rangle]_\Gamma: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, z_1: C_1] \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_{m-1}, t_2 \rangle]_\Gamma: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, z_2: C_2[z_1 \leftarrow t_1]] \\ \vdots \\ [\langle y_1, \dots, y_{m-1}, t_w \rangle]_\Gamma: [\Delta] \rightarrow [\Delta, z_w: C_w[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]]. \end{aligned}$$

So by applying the expansion rule E3 to $[\Delta]$, we have that $[\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, F[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w] \rangle]_\Gamma = [\langle y_1, \dots, y_m, t \rangle]_\Gamma$ is constructible by expansion. $\square$

Theorem 2.18. *Every object and every morphism of $\mathcal{C}_{\Sigma, \Gamma}$ are constructible by expansion.*

Proof. This follows directly from Lemma 2.17 and the proof of Theorem 1.23. $\square$

Chapter 3

Implementation of the Expansion Algorithm

In this chapter, we explain the basic ideas of how to use the Expansion Algorithm jointly with graph neural networks to generate terms of a specific type. Before attempting to navigate the complex, strictly functorial pullbacks required by CoC, we must prove that GNN-guided graph exploration is viable in a minimal setting. Therefore, we present a demo of the raw Expansion Algorithm on Simply Typed Combinatory Logic ($\mathbf{CL}_{\rightarrow}$) to serve as a chronological and computational baseline, providing intuition on how the algorithm works and demonstrating the inherent combinatorial explosion.

3.1 Term Generation in Simply Typed Combinatory Logic

Now we present the `IMPLICA` package for Python [14], a graph engine built on Rust that we built for the purpose of this demonstration. The idea of this package is to allocate the finite subcategory G described in the expansion algorithm, and help to apply the different expansion iterations via its cypher-like interface directly from Python.

We start by stating what simply typed Combinatory Logic, or $\mathbf{CL}_{\rightarrow}$ is. This definition is taken from [28].

Definition 3.1. Given a countable set of type variables $P_0, P_1, P_2, \dots$, we define the set of *simple types* $\mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow}$ as the set generated by the following clauses:

1. type variables belong to $\mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow}$;
2. if $A, B \in \mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow}$, then $(A \rightarrow B) \in \mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow}$.

Types of the form $A \rightarrow B$ are called *function types*, and are the simply typed version of the product types we introduced in CoC.

Definition 3.2. Terms of $\mathbf{CL}_{\rightarrow}$ must have a type assigned and are generated by the following clauses:

1. for each $A \in \mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow}$ there is a countably infinite supply of variables of type A ;
2. if t, s are terms of types $A \rightarrow B$ and A respectively, then $App(t, s)$ is a term of type B ;
3. for all $A, B, C \in \mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow}$ there are constant terms

$$\mathbf{k}^{A,B}: A \rightarrow B \rightarrow A$$

$$\mathbf{s}^{A,B,C}: (A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C) \rightarrow (A \rightarrow B) \rightarrow A \rightarrow C.$$

We use the following notation: To assert that t is a term of type A , we write $t: A$; instead of writing $App(t, s)$ we can simply write (ts) . In the case of iterated implications we sometimes use the short notation

$$A_1 \rightarrow A_2 \rightarrow \dots A_{n-1} \rightarrow A_n \quad \text{for} \quad A_1 \rightarrow (A_2 \rightarrow \dots (A_{n-1} \rightarrow A_n) \dots).$$

Similarly, for iterated application we write

$$t_1 t_2 \dots t_n \quad \text{for} \quad (\dots ((t_1 t_2) t_3 \dots) t_n).$$

We can write this as a GAT signature as follows:

$$\vdash Prop \text{ type}$$

$$p: Prop \vdash Proof(p) \text{ type}$$

$$A, B: Prop \vdash (A \rightarrow B): Prop$$

$$A, B: Prop, t: Proof(A \rightarrow B), s: Proof(A) \vdash App(t, s): Proof(B)$$

$$A, B: Prop \vdash \mathbf{k}^{A,B}: Proof(A \rightarrow B \rightarrow A)$$

$$A, B, C: Prop \vdash \mathbf{s}^{A,B,C}: Proof((A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C) \rightarrow (A \rightarrow B) \rightarrow A \rightarrow C).$$

This allows us to build upon the construction of $C(U)$ we made for the general case, but this will be rather difficult to follow. Hence, we look for a simplification of both the category and the expansion rules. Consider Γ a simple type expression of $\mathbf{CL}_{\rightarrow}$, let $A_1, \dots, A_n$ be the type variables appearing on Γ , and let $\Delta = A_1: Prop, \dots, A_n: Prop$. We center our search on the relativization of $C(U)$ by Δ , $\mathcal{C}_{\Delta}$. Although the category $\mathcal{C}_{\Delta}$ carries a lot of information, i.e., its tree structure, dependent types and pullbacks, in this simple case it becomes somehow redundant. We then consider the full category composed by the first level of objects and the terminal object, this subcategory contains all possible types in $A_1, \dots, A_n$ and the relations between them. Moreover, the object $[\Delta, x: Prop]$ lies in the *level 1*, but it carries no important information in our case, as it is just used for object formation by the general expansion algorithm, but that will be done differently in this special case, so we will remove it. So we can consider $\mathcal{C}$ to be

the full subcategory of $C(U)$ containing $[\Delta]$ and $[\Delta, x: \text{Proof}(p)]$ for each term p of type Prop under context Δ . The objects of this category are in 1-1-correspondence with the elements of $\mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow} \cup \{1\}$, hence we note

$$1 := [\Delta] \quad \text{and} \quad p := [\Delta, x: \text{Proof}(p)].$$

In the case of morphisms, we note them by the term appearing in the $n + 1$ component, i.e., each morphism $\langle A_1, \dots, A_n, s \rangle$ in $\mathcal{C}$ will be noted as just s . With this notation in mind, we define the following rules of expansion: Let p be an element of $\mathcal{T}_{\rightarrow}$:

1. if p is of the form $B \rightarrow A$, we add $A \xrightarrow{k^{A,B}} p$;
2. for each q in G_n we add $p \xrightarrow{k^{p,q}} q \rightarrow p$;
3. if p is of the form $(B \rightarrow A) \rightarrow A \rightarrow C$, we add $(A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C) \xrightarrow{s^{A,B,C}} p$;
4. if p is of the form $(A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C)$, we add $p \xrightarrow{s^{A,B,C}} ((A \rightarrow B) \rightarrow A \rightarrow C)$.

Also, when creating an object p , if p is of the form $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow A$, add the morphism $k^{A,B}: 1 \rightarrow p$, and if p is of the form $(A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C) \rightarrow (A \rightarrow B) \rightarrow A \rightarrow C$, add the morphism $s^{A,B,C}: 1 \rightarrow p$. Then, complete G_{n+1} with the composition of morphisms in order for it to be a subcategory of $\mathcal{C}$. When adding an object we are also adding its projection to 1. The exhaustivity of this expansion algorithm is easy to check, as it follows directly from the definitions.

Now we show how to code the expansion algorithm using Python and the `IMPLICA` package. For this initial $\mathbf{CL}_{\rightarrow}$ baseline, we adopt a classical approach where all proofs of a proposition are treated as geometrically identical. While this deliberately collapses the constructive proof relevance inherent to dependent type theories, it allows us to isolate and observe the raw combinatorial explosion of the Expansion Algorithm without the added overhead of undecidable object identity. In order to add this condition to the GAT signature, it is enough to add the following equation:

$$p: \text{Prop}, t_1, t_2: \text{Proof}(p) \vdash t_1 = t_2.$$

As it is not really part of combinatory logic, we left it out of its formal definition, but for our task it is more efficient to consider it this way.

First we initialize an `IMPLICA` graph and we add the proposition $A \rightarrow A$ using the query API.

```
import implica

# Initialize the graph with Combinatory Logic constants
graph = implica.Graph(
    constants = [
```

```

        implica.Constant(("K", "(A:*)->(B:*)->A")),
        implica.Constant("S", "((A:*)->(B:*)->(C:*))->(A->B)->A->C")
    ]
)

```

```

# Seed the graph with our target objective (A -> A)
graph.query().create("(:A->A)").execute()

```

Now, to perform one expansion iteration we execute the following code:

```

# Mark all current nodes as 'existed' to differentiate them
# from new generations
graph.query().match("(N:*)").set("N", { "existed" : True }).execute()

# Rule 1 & 2: K-Combinator Expansions
(
    self.graph.query()
    # Find existing nodes matching the signature of a K-target
    .match("(N:(B:*) -> (A:*) { existed: true })")
    # Create the precursor node and the connecting morphism
    .create("(: A { existed: false })-[::@K(A, B)]->(N)")
    .execute()
)
(
    self.graph.query()
    .match("(N:(A:*) { existed: true })")
    # CRITICAL: Limit creation number to prevent memory overflow
    .limit(10)
    .match("(M:(B:*) { existed: true })")
    .create("(N)-[::@K(A, B)]->(:B -> A { existed: false })")
    .execute()
)
# Rule 3 & 4: S-Combinator Expansions
(
    self.graph.query()
    .match("(N:((A:*) -> (B:*)) -> A -> (C:*) { existed: true })")
    .create("(:A->B->C { existed: false })-[::@S(A, B, C)]->(N)")
    .execute()
)
(
    self.graph.query()

```

```

    .match("(N:(A:*)->(B:*)->(C:*) { existed: true })")
    .create("(N)-[:@S(A, B, C)]->:(A -> B) -> A -> C { existed: false })")
    .execute()
)

```

In the first line, we set an attribute ‘existed’ to true in order to distinguish between new nodes and nodes already present at the beginning. It is important to state the *.limit* modifier on the second query, because this expansion rule creates, or tries to create a new node for each pair of nodes in the graph, hence it makes complexity explode. To solve this we use the modifier *.limit* to cap the number of creations per original node to 10. Feel free to remove this line. This explosive growth of the complexity of the algorithm is what we will try to solve later by adding graph neural networks.

Let us walk through, iteration by iteration, on the generation of a term of type $A \rightarrow A$ by the expansion algorithm to get some intuition. For simplicity, we have omitted the 1 element on the graph displays, and also, as we just want witnesses of the existence of a term, we just have at most one morphism between two objects, and the sections (morphisms from 1) will be displayed simply as red dots instead of blue. Appendix C contains images of the graphs we will be mentioning now. The starting point G_0 is rather uninteresting, as it just contains the object $A \rightarrow A$ with no section. In the Figure C.1a, we can see that G_1 contains three unpopulated objects A , $A \rightarrow A$ and $(A \rightarrow A) \rightarrow A \rightarrow A$ from left to right. Then, by applying another expansion, we obtain G_2 , Figure C.1b, where we start to see some objects getting populated, for example $(A \rightarrow A) \rightarrow A \rightarrow A$ with term $\mathbf{s k}$. By the next expansion, G_3 grows significantly, see Figure C.1c, but $A \rightarrow A$ remains unpopulated. Finally, in G_4 $A \rightarrow A$ gets inhabited by the term $\mathbf{s k k}$, but as can be seen in Figure C.1d, the exponential growth of the graph continues.

Iteration (G_n)	Nodes (Capped at 10/match)	Nodes (Uncapped)
G_0	1	1
G_1	3	3
G_2	11	11
G_3	116	123
G_4	1352	15131

Table 3.1: Node count explosion during the expansion algorithm for the proof of $A \rightarrow A$ in $CL_{\rightarrow}$.

Now that we have a clearer understanding of how the expansion algorithm works, we introduce the optimizations for the general case.

3.2 Graph Neural Networks

Graph Neural Networks (GNNs) process complex data structures by leveraging relationships between individual data points (nodes) and their connections (edges) through a mechanism known as *message passing*. During this process, each node iteratively updates its own representation by gathering and aggregating information from its immediate neighbors, enabling the model to learn both the local features of the data and the broader structural geometry of the network. Because of this unique architecture, GNNs are highly effective for node classification (assigning specific labels to individual nodes), graph classification (categorizing the entire network structure as a single entity), and graph embedding (translating complex graph structures into lower-dimensional vectors for easier processing in downstream machine learning tasks) [32, 33].

The core of our expansion algorithm leverages these GNN capabilities to process the graph structures that emerge from the categorical semantics presented in previous chapters. The system operates alongside a GNN trained for node classification. We treat the GNN as a labeler. Given a finite subcategory G_n produced by the previous expansion step, the GNN classifies each node into one of three categories: KEEP, EXPAND, or DELETE.

Next, we execute a partial expansion phase to compute G_{n+1} from G_n . We remove any nodes labeled as DELETE and apply the expansion operation exclusively to nodes marked as EXPAND. While pruning the graph sacrifices absolute exhaustivity, it yields massive gains in computational efficiency. In an ideal scenario where the GNN perfectly classifies nodes, the model can still generate terms of any type but with drastically reduced complexity by successfully pruning irrelevant branches.

Although a full implementation of this algorithm is left for future work, we outline the foundational architecture for this labeling model.

Using supervised learning requires a vast dataset of input-output pairs generated by the raw expansion algorithm. Due to the algorithm’s high baseline complexity, generating a sufficient volume of training data for anything beyond trivial examples is computationally prohibitive. Similar constraints have been noted in [31].

To overcome this, we rely on an unsupervised learning framework known as the Teacher-Student or Conjecturer-Prover model [11, 24, 27]. This involves a two-headed model sharing a common GNN body:

- **Conjecturer (Teacher):** Proposes a challenge—in our case, a specific type for which a term must be found.
- **Prover (Student):** Acts as the GNN labeler, attempting to construct the term using the partial expansion algorithm.

If the Prover successfully finds a solution, we determine the optimal node labels for

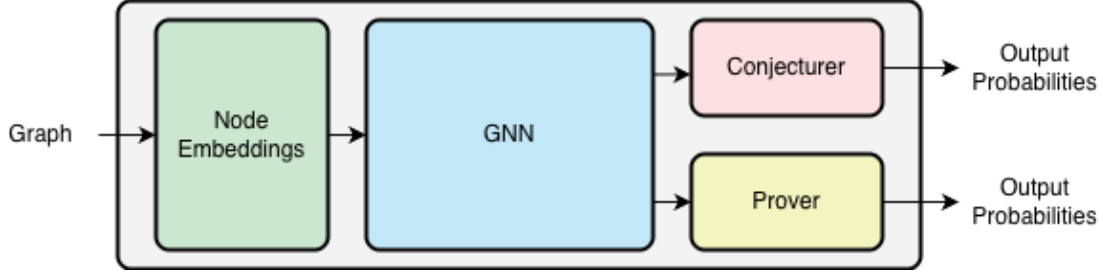


Figure 3.1: Base architecture diagram

each step of that successful path and use them to compute the Prover’s loss. The Conjecturer’s loss is then computed by measuring the deviation of the Prover’s loss from a target loss. This dynamic ensures the Conjecturer consistently generates challenges with an appropriate level of difficulty, guiding the Prover’s learning process.

We break down the architecture into four primary components:

- **Node Embedding:** This component assigns numerical vectors (embeddings) to the input graph’s nodes, capturing their core syntactic meaning independent of the broader graph structure. If operating with a fixed signature, the model can learn basic embeddings for all sort and operator symbols. To strictly preserve α -equivalence and prevent the model from treating structurally identical graphs differently, variable embeddings are generated deterministically using the de Bruijn indices. This guarantees that bound variables share the exact same geometric representation regardless of their syntactic naming. Then use small transformer-based encoders to generate embeddings for complex expressions. Developing a foundational model for any arbitrary signature by solely learning aggregation operations remains an area for future research.
- **GNN Body:** A message-passing GNN processes the baseline embeddings, enriching them into structure-aware representations. Because the directionality of morphisms is vital in this categorical setup, the chosen architecture must strictly support directed edges.
- **Conjecturer:** A linear projection layer maps the original embedding dimension to a 3-dimensional vector, classifying nodes as OBJECTIVE, INCLUDE, or EXCLUDE. Since only one node can serve as the target, the node with the highest OBJECTIVE score is selected. A *softmax function* [16] is then applied to the remaining two components across all other nodes to assign INCLUDE and EXCLUDE labels. The Prover’s challenge is to generate a section of the OBJECTIVE node using a subgraph composed only of the OBJECTIVE node and the INCLUDE nodes. Any morphisms arising from composition or currying that involve an EXCLUDE node are discarded.

- **Prover:** Similar to the Conjecturer, this is a linear layer mapping to a 3-dimensional vector, followed by a softmax activation. It classifies nodes as KEEP, EXPAND, or DELETE. To provide better context, the embedding of the objective node can be concatenated with the target node’s embedding before passing it to this component.

A significant hurdle in training this model is the *cold start* problem. Initially, the system starts with an empty graph, and an untrained Conjecturer will yield nonsensical challenges. To pre-train the model before initiating the unsupervised loop, we seed it with a highly solvable target type (e.g., $A \rightarrow A$), ensuring the expansion finds a term in very few iterations. The resulting successful expansion paths form a foundational graph, providing reliable, simple examples to initially train the Conjecturer

Because the uncapped Expansion Algorithm grows super-exponentially (as evidenced in Table 3.1), an untrained Prover making greedy, near-random softmax predictions will face extreme reward sparsity—it will exhaust computational memory before ever finding a valid proof path to learn from. If permitted to dictate the partial expansion path immediately, the Prover would likely trigger catastrophic failures by aggressively pruning vital nodes. Therefore, the decaying confidence threshold is strictly paired with Curriculum Learning. By seeding the model entirely with trivial theorems during pre-training (where the baseline algorithm naturally terminates), we guarantee initial positive reward signals. This allows the GNN to learn basic pruning heuristics before the threshold decays and more complex search spaces are introduced.

To mitigate this and stabilize early training, we introduce a dynamic confidence threshold for the DELETE action, denoted as a function $f(x)$, where x represents the current training step. Rather than strictly selecting the label with the highest softmax probability, the Prover’s predicted DELETE action is only executed if its confidence score, $P(\text{DELETE})$, strictly exceeds this threshold.

Utilizing a constant function for $f(x)$ provides little to no benefit; a permanently high threshold would artificially cap the complexity of objects our model can handle by permanently restricting its ability to prune deep subgraphs. Conversely, a permanently low threshold would fail to protect the early training phase. Therefore, we define $f(x)$ as an exponentially decaying confidence baseline:

$$f(x) = (a - b)e^{-cx} + b$$

where a , b , and c are strictly positive hyperparameters representing the initial strictness, the lower-bound asymptote, and the decay rate, respectively. As the training step x increases, the confidence baseline $f(x)$ progressively decays. This dynamic schedule protects the structural integrity of the graph during the earliest phases of learning, while smoothly granting the Prover increasing autonomy to aggressively slice through the combinatorial explosion as its representations become more accurate.

Conclusion

This thesis started as a problem proposed by one of my supervisors, Dr. Joost J. Joosten, that consisted in generating terms of specific types in simply typed combinatory logic $\mathbf{CL}_{\rightarrow}$. Our initial work building a language model to generate those terms made the limitations of language models very clear. First, linear generation forces the model to overcommit too soon to certain solution paths, resulting in unsatisfactory results. This was also noted by researchers in Logical Intelligence in [22]. Second, that syntax does not hold all the information the model needed to generate the desired terms.

Our study of Lafforgue’s framework [19, 20] connecting Topos Theory [21] with Artificial Intelligence, led us to consider working with categorical representations of our type theory in order to leverage its geometrical properties to give the model a complete picture of the semantics of the theory.

This motivated the development of *IMPLICA*, discussed in Section 3.1. Although it served its purpose of showcasing the base concepts behind the expansion algorithm, for future iteration of this architecture we must critically re-evaluate fundamental design trade-offs. The initial implementation prioritized a highly general, Cypher-like [15], programming interface to facilitate broad pattern matching and generalized graph querying. While computationally versatile, this abstraction layer introduced computational overhead and made the backtracking algorithm, which is essential for computing the optimal target labels for our GNN, prohibitively difficult and computationally unwieldy.

In our effort to extend these ideas to the general case, the first representation we found promising was Cartmell’s Generalized Algebraic Theories and Contextual Categories [6, 7], whose term models sit close enough to the syntax of a theory to be computationally manageable, while still carrying the geometric structure needed for a GNN-based approach. In Section 1.3 we revised the definition of model of a GAT, that originally is thought as a mapping to the category of sets, families of sets, families of families of sets, $\dots$; but we thought it was more natural to think of an interpretation as a mapping directly to a contextual category. With this revised notion of model, we adapted the proof of initiality of the term model for GATs to our new notion of

model. Then we designed the Expansion Algorithm to construct sections within the term model, equivalent to generating terms of a given type. This model was thought to work together with a GNN in order to surpass the complexity barrier.

To handle a more expressive type theory, we turned to Streicher’s work on the Calculus of Constructions and Doctrines of Constructions [26], which provided both a proof of the Initiality Conjecture for CoC and a framework for extending type theories beyond GATs. In Section 2.5, we extended this framework to CoC enriched with a GAT signature and constructed the corresponding term model, following ideas from [4]. The proofs of completeness and initiality of this term model are still open for future work. We then extended the Expansion Algorithm to this richer setting. To do this, we extended the concept of relativization to Doctrines of Constructions. In the course of this work, we also identified a connection between the concept of collections of types in Doctrines of Constructions and the topos-theoretic notion of subobject classifier [23], which we leave as a direction for further investigation.

While Cartmell’s original formulation of contextual categories provided the necessary foundational scaffolding to model the expansion algorithm, scaling the semantic interpretation requires transitioning to more modern paradigms. Future research should systematically reconstruct the underlying categorical models utilizing Voevodsky’s C-systems [29] and Categories with Families (CwFs) [13]. By transitioning away from early contextual categories and adopting these streamlined, modern frameworks, the underlying geometry of the automated expansion algorithm will achieve greater mathematical elegance and absolute alignment with the current state-of-the-art in type-theoretic research.

It remains to formally extend the term model construction and prove the Initiality Conjecture for Doctrines of Constructions with Σ -types, identity types, and a universe hierarchy, as described in [26], and ultimately for the full Calculus of Inductive Constructions [9, 25] and the Lean type theory [10]. The Initiality Conjecture for full Martin-Löf type theory has been formalized in Agda by Brunerie and Lumsdaine [5], and a similar formalization effort for our extended setting would be a natural next step.

On the practical side, the full implementation of the GNN-based Conjecturer-Prover model for guiding the Expansion Algorithm remains the primary target for future work. We believe this architecture, by combining the geometric structure of categorical term models with the pruning power of graph neural networks, offers a principled and promising alternative to purely syntactic approaches to autonomous theorem proving.

Appendix A

Derivation Rules

We denote ‘from $S_1, \dots, S_n$ derive S' ’, where $S_1, \dots, S_n, S$ are rules or sequents, as follows:

$$\frac{S_1 \quad \dots \quad S_n}{S}$$

Also, we write

$$\frac{S_2}{S_1} \text{ abbreviates } \frac{S_1}{S_2} \text{ and } \frac{S_2}{S_1}$$

A.1 Derivation Rules of Generalized Algebraic Theories

In this section, we state the derivation rules of Generalized Algebraic Theories as presented in [7], but with a more compact notation.

$$\text{LI1 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}}{\Gamma \vdash A = A} \quad \text{LI2 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash t : A}{\Gamma \vdash t = t : A} \quad \text{LI3 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2}{\Gamma \vdash A_2 = A_1} \quad \text{LI4 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_2 : A}{\Gamma \vdash t_2 = t_1 : A}$$

$$\text{LI5 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2 \quad \Gamma \vdash A_2 = A_3}{A_1 = A_3} \quad \text{LI6 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_2 : A \quad \Gamma \vdash t_2 = t_3 : A}{\Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_3 : A}$$

$$\text{LI7 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_2 : A_1 \quad \Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2}{t_1 = t_2 : A_2} \quad \text{T1 } \frac{\Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2 \quad \Gamma \vdash t : A_1}{\Gamma \vdash t : A_2}$$

CF1 For $n \geq 0, 1 \leq i \leq n+1$:

$$\frac{x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_n : A_n \vdash A_{n+1} \text{ type}}{x_1 : A_1, \dots, x_{n+1} : A_{n+1} \vdash x_i : A_i}$$

provided that x_{n+1} is a variable distinct from all $x_1, \dots, x_n$.

CF2(A) For every sort symbol S with well-formed introductory rule

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash S(x_1, \dots, x_n) \text{ type},$$

for every context Γ ,

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash t_1: A_1 \quad \dots \quad \Gamma \vdash t_n: A_n[x_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, x_{n-1} \leftarrow t_{n-1}]}{\Gamma \vdash S(t_1, \dots, t_n) \text{ type}}$$

CF2(B) For every operator symbol F with well-formed introductory rule

$$x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash F(x_1, \dots, x_n): A,$$

for every context P ,

$$\frac{\Gamma \vdash t_1: A_1 \quad \dots \quad \Gamma \vdash t_n: A_n[x_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, x_{n-1} \leftarrow t_{n-1}]}{\Gamma \vdash F(t_1, \dots, t_n): A[x_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow t_n]}$$

SI1 If Γ is a context, then

$$\frac{x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A = A' \quad \Gamma \vdash s_1 = s'_1: A_1 \quad \dots \quad \Gamma \vdash s_m = s'_m: A_n[x_1 \leftarrow s_1, \dots, x_{n-1} \leftarrow s_{n-1}]}{\Gamma \vdash A[x_1 \leftarrow s_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow s_n] = A'[x_1 \leftarrow s'_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow s'_n]}$$

SI2 If Γ is a context, then

$$\frac{x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash s = s': A \quad \Gamma \vdash s_1 = s'_1: A_1 \quad \dots \quad \Gamma \vdash s_n = s'_n: A_n[x_1 \leftarrow s_1, \dots, x_{n-1} \leftarrow s_{n-1}]}{s[x_1 \leftarrow s_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow s_n] = s'[x_1 \leftarrow s'_1, \dots, x_n \leftarrow s'_n]}$$

A1 If $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A = A'$ is an axiom, then

$$\frac{x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A \text{ type} \quad x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A' \text{ type}}{x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash A = A'}$$

A2 If $x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t = t': A$ is an axiom, then from

$$\frac{x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t: A \quad x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t': A}{x_1: A_1, \dots, x_n: A_n \vdash t = t': A}$$

A.2 Derivation Rules of Calculus of Constructions

In this section, we state all the derivation rules for CoC as presented in [26].

Context Formation Rules:

$$\begin{array}{c}
\text{EMPTY} \quad \frac{}{ok} \qquad \text{CONT-INTRO} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A \text{ ok}}{\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}}, \text{ if } x \notin \text{Var}(\Gamma) \\
\\
\text{CONT-THIN} \quad \frac{\Gamma, \Delta \text{ ok} \quad \Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}}{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta \text{ ok}}, \text{ if } x \notin \text{Var}(\Gamma) \cup \text{Var}(\Delta) \\
\\
\text{CONT-SUB} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta \text{ ok} \quad \Gamma \vdash t: A}{\Gamma, \Delta[x \leftarrow t] \text{ ok}}
\end{array}$$

Context Equality Rules:

$$\begin{array}{c}
\text{CREFL} \quad \frac{\Gamma = \Gamma}{\Gamma \text{ ok}} \qquad \text{CSYM} \quad \frac{\Gamma = \Delta}{\Delta = \Gamma} \qquad \text{CTRANS} \quad \frac{\Gamma = \Delta \quad \Delta = \Theta}{\Gamma = \Theta} \\
\\
\text{CEQU} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta \text{ ok} \quad \Gamma \vdash A = B}{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta = \Gamma, x: B, \Delta} \qquad \text{CREFLECT1} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A = \Delta, x: B}{\Gamma = \Delta} \\
\\
\text{CREFLECT2} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A = \Delta, x: B}{\Gamma \vdash A = B}
\end{array}$$

Structural Rules for Judgement Formation

$$\begin{array}{c}
\text{ASS} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta \text{ ok}}{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta \vdash x: A} \qquad \text{REFLECTION1} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash \mathcal{J}}{\Gamma \text{ ok}} \qquad \text{REFLECTION2} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t: A}{\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}} \\
\\
\text{THIN} \quad \frac{\Gamma, \Delta \vdash \mathcal{J} \quad \Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}}{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta \vdash \mathcal{J}}, \text{ if } x \notin \text{Var}(\Gamma) \cup \text{Var}(\Delta) \\
\\
\text{SUB} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A, \Delta \vdash \mathcal{J} \quad \Gamma \vdash t: A}{\Gamma, \Delta[x \leftarrow t] \vdash \mathcal{J}[x \leftarrow t]}
\end{array}$$

Equality Rules:

$$\begin{array}{c}
\text{EQU} \quad \frac{\Gamma = \Delta \quad \Gamma \vdash \mathcal{J}}{\Delta \vdash \mathcal{J}} \qquad \text{REFL-TYP} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A \text{ type}}{\Gamma \vdash A = A} \qquad \text{REFL-OBJ} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t : A}{\Gamma \vdash t = t : A} \\
\\
\text{SYMM-TYP} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A = B}{\Gamma \vdash B = A} \qquad \text{SYMM-OBJ} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t = s : A}{\Gamma \vdash s = t : A} \\
\\
\text{TRANS-TYP} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A = B \quad \Gamma \vdash B = C}{\Gamma \vdash A = C} \\
\\
\text{TRANS-OBJ} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_2 : A \quad \Gamma \vdash t_2 = t_3 : A}{\Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_3 : A} \\
\\
\text{REPL1} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t = s : A \quad \Gamma, x : A, \Delta \text{ ok}}{\Gamma, \Delta[x \leftarrow t] = \Gamma, \Delta[x \leftarrow t]} \\
\\
\text{REPL2} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t = s : A \quad \Gamma, x : A, \Delta \vdash B \text{ type}}{\Gamma, \Delta[x \leftarrow t] \vdash B[x \leftarrow t] = B[x \leftarrow s]} \\
\\
\text{REPL3} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_2 : A \quad \Gamma, x : A, \Delta \vdash s : B}{\Gamma, \Delta[x \leftarrow t_1] \vdash s[x \leftarrow t_1] = s[x \leftarrow t_2] : B[x \leftarrow t_1]} \\
\\
\text{CONV1} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A = B \quad \Gamma \vdash t : A}{\Gamma \vdash t : B} \qquad \text{CONV2} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A = B \quad \Gamma \vdash t = s : A}{\Gamma \vdash t = s : B}
\end{array}$$

Rules for products of types:

$$\begin{array}{c}
\text{PII-FORM} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x : A \vdash B \text{ type}}{\Gamma \vdash (\Pi x : A) B \text{ type}} \qquad \text{PII-EQU} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2 \quad \Gamma, x : A_1 \vdash B_1 = B_2}{\Gamma \vdash (\Pi x : A_1) B_1 = (\Pi x : A_2) B_2} \\
\\
\text{PII-INTRO} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x : A \vdash t : B}{\Gamma \vdash (\lambda x : A) t : (\Pi x : A) B}
\end{array}$$

$$\zeta\text{-RULE} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A_1 \vdash t_1 = t_2: B \quad \Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2}{\Gamma \vdash (\lambda x: A_1) t_1 = (\lambda x: A_2) t_2: (\Pi x: A_1) B}$$

$$\Pi\text{-ELIM} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash t: (\Pi x: A) B \quad \Gamma \vdash s: A \quad \Gamma, x: A \vdash B \text{ type}}{\Gamma \vdash \text{App}([x: A] B, t, s): B[x \leftarrow s]}$$

$$\Pi\text{-ELIM-EQU} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2 \quad \Gamma \vdash t_1 = t_2: (\Pi x: A_1) B_1 \quad \Gamma, x: A_1 \vdash B_1 = B_2 \quad \Gamma \vdash s_1 = s_2: A_1}{\Gamma \vdash \text{App}([x: A_1] B_1, t_1, s_1) = \text{App}([x: A_2] B_2, t_2, s_2): B_1[x \leftarrow s_1]}$$

$$\beta\text{-RULE} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A \vdash B \text{ type} \quad \Gamma, x: A \vdash t: B \quad \Gamma \vdash s: A}{\Gamma \vdash \text{App}([x: A] B, (\lambda x: A) t, s) = t[x \leftarrow s]: B[x \leftarrow s]}$$

$$\eta\text{-RULE} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A \vdash B \text{ type} \quad \Gamma \vdash t: (\Pi x: A) B}{\Gamma \vdash (\lambda x: A) \text{App}([x: A] B, t, x) = t: (\Pi x: A) B}$$

Rules for Propositions

$$\text{PROP} \quad \frac{\Gamma \text{ ok}}{\Gamma \vdash \text{Prop type}}$$

$$\text{PROP-TYPE} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash \text{Proof}(p) \text{ type}}{\Gamma \vdash p: \text{Prop}}$$

$$\text{PROP-EQU} \quad \frac{\Gamma \vdash \text{Proof}(p_1) = \text{Proof}(p_2)}{\Gamma \vdash p_1 = p_2: \text{Prop}}$$

$$\forall\text{-INTRO} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A \vdash p: \text{Prop}}{\Gamma \vdash (\forall x: A) p: \text{Prop}}$$

$$\forall\text{-EQU} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A_1 \vdash p_1 = p_2: \text{Prop} \quad \Gamma \vdash A_1 = A_2}{\Gamma \vdash (\forall x: A_1) p_1 = (\forall x: A_2) p_2: \text{Prop}}$$

$$\forall\text{-ELIM} \quad \frac{\Gamma, x: A \vdash p \in \text{Prop}}{\Gamma \vdash \text{Proof}((\forall x: A) p) = (\Pi x: A) \text{Proof}(p)}$$

Appendix B

Proof of Inversion Lemmas

Now we prove the inversion lemmas by simultaneous structural induction on derivation height.

Lemma 2.14. *Given a derivable sequent of the form $\Gamma \vdash A$ type there are four possible cases:*

1. *A is equal to Prop;*
2. *A is equal to Proof(p) for some pre-object-expression p and $\Gamma \vdash p : \text{Prop}$ is derivable;*
3. *A is equal to $(\Pi x : B)C$ for pre-type-expressions B, C and a variable x, such that $\Gamma, x : B \vdash C$ type is a derivable sequent;*
4. *there exists a sort symbol S in Σ with an introductory rule*

$$y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m \vdash S \text{ type}$$

and sequents

$$\Gamma \vdash t_1 : B_1$$

$$\Gamma \vdash t_2 : B_2[y_1 \leftarrow t_1]$$

$$\vdots$$

$$\Gamma \vdash t_m : B_m[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_{m-1} \leftarrow t_{m-1}]$$

such that A is equal to $S[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m]$.

Proof. The four cases are mutually exclusive by the unique outermost constructor of pre-type-expressions (the BNF grammar for E is unambiguous). We proceed by induction on $|\pi|$, with case analysis on the last rule applied.

Group I: Direct Type Formation Rules

These immediately yield the required form and witnesses.

PROP We have that $A = Prop$, this is Case 1.

PROP-TYPE Then $A = Proof(p)$ and $\Gamma \vdash p : Prop$ as a sub-derivation. This is Case 2.

II-FORM Then $A = (\Pi x : B)C$ and $\Gamma, x : B \vdash C \text{ type}$ as a sub-derivation. This is Case 3.

INTRODUCTORY RULE Then, there exists a sort symbol $S \in \Sigma$ with an introductory rule

$$z_1 : C_1, \dots, z_w : C_w \vdash S \text{ type},$$

and derivable rules

$$\Gamma \vdash t_1 : C_1, \dots, \Gamma \vdash t_w : C_w [z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_{w-1} \leftarrow t_{w-1}]$$

such that $A = S[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]$. This is Case 4.

Group II: Context-Structural Rules

These change the context but not the outermost constructor of A ; the case is transferred by applying the same rule to each sub-derivation.

EQU By applying the induction hypothesis to $\Delta \vdash A \text{ type}$ (smaller $|\pi|$). One of the four cases holds in context Δ . Transfer each to Γ :

Case 1 Trivially holds for Γ .

Case 2 Apply EQU with $\Gamma = \Delta$ (from $\Delta = \Gamma$ by **CSYM**) to get $\Gamma \vdash p : Prop$.

Case 3 From $\Delta = \Gamma$ derive $\Delta, x : B = \Gamma, x : B$ by **CEQU**. Apply EQU to get $\Gamma, x : B \vdash C \text{ type}$.

Case 4 Apply EQU to each typing.

THIN Apply the induction hypothesis to $\Gamma, \Delta \vdash A \text{ type}$. Transfer sub-derivations to $(\Gamma, y : B, \Delta)$ using **THIN** (using **CONT-THIN** for the extended context in Case 3). All four cases transfer.

SUB Apply the induction hypothesis to $\Gamma, y : B, \Delta \vdash A \text{ type}$. Substitution preserves the outermost constructor.

Case 1 : $A[y \leftarrow s] = Prop$.

Case 2 : $A[y \leftarrow s] = Proof(p[y \leftarrow s])$. Apply SUB to $\Gamma, y : B, \Delta \vdash p : Prop$ to obtain $\Gamma, \Delta[y \leftarrow s] \vdash p[y \leftarrow s] : Prop$.

Case 3 : $A[y \leftarrow s] = (\Pi x : C[y \leftarrow s])D[y \leftarrow s]$. Apply SUB to $\Gamma, y : B, \Delta, x : C \vdash D \text{ type}$ to obtain $\Gamma, \Delta[y \leftarrow s], x : C[y \leftarrow s] \vdash D[y \leftarrow s] \text{ type}$.

Case 4 : $A[y \leftarrow s] = S[z_i \leftarrow t_i[y \leftarrow s]]$. Apply SUB to each typing derivation using $(C_i[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots])[y \leftarrow s] = C_i[z_1 \leftarrow t_1[y \leftarrow s], \dots]$.

Group III: The Reflection and Equality Rules

REFLECTION2 The sub-derivation $\pi' : \Gamma \vdash t : A$ satisfies $|\pi'| < |\pi|$. Apply Lemma 2.15 by induction hypothesis to π' , we get 5 cases:

Case 1 Let $\Gamma = \Gamma_0, x : A, \Gamma_1$. Context Γ was formed by CONT-INTRO from $\Gamma_0 \vdash A$ type. By applying THIN, $\Gamma \vdash A$ type is derivable by a shorter derivation. Apply the IH.

Case 2 From $\Gamma, x : B \vdash s : C$, apply REFLECTION2 to get $\Gamma, x : B \vdash C$ type. This is Case 3.

Case 3 From $\Gamma, x : B \vdash C$ type and $\Gamma \vdash r : B$, apply SUB to obtain $\Gamma \vdash C[x \leftarrow r]$ type by a shorter derivation. Apply the IH.

Case 4 This is Case 1.

Case 5 Apply REFLECTION2 to $\Gamma \vdash F[z_i \leftarrow t_i] : D[z_i \leftarrow t_i]$ (shorter) to get $\Gamma \vdash A$ type. Apply the IH.

REFL-TYP A is syntactically of forms (1)-(4). We proceed by inner induction on the derivation of $\Gamma \vdash A = A$:

REFL-TYP The derivation of $\Gamma \vdash A$ type is strictly shorter; apply the outer induction hypothesis.

II-EQU From $\Gamma, x : B \vdash C = C$, apply REFL-TYP (IH) to extract $\Gamma, x : B \vdash C$ type. This is Case 3.

PROP-EQU From $\Gamma \vdash p = p : Prop$, apply REFL-OBJ to extract $\Gamma \vdash p : Prop$. This is Case 2.

$\forall$ -ELIM $\Gamma \vdash Proof((\forall x : B)p) = (\Pi x : B) Proof(p)$. If $A = Proof((\forall x : B)p)$, it is Case 2. If $A \equiv (\Pi x : B) Proof(p)$, it is Case 3. $\square$

Lemma 2.15. *Given a derivable sequent of the form $\Gamma \vdash t : A$ there are five possible cases:*

1. *there exists a variable x in $Var(\Gamma)$, such that t equals x ;*
2. *t is equal to $(\lambda x : B)s$ and A is equal to $(\Pi x : B)C$ for some pre-type-expressions B, C , a pre-object-expression s and variable x ;*
3. *t is equal to $App([x : B]C, s, r)$ and A is equal to $C[x \leftarrow r]$ for some pre-type-expressions B, C , pre-object-expressions s, r and variable x ;*
4. *t is equal to $(\forall x : B)s$ and A is equal to $Prop$ for some pre-type-expression B , pre-object-expression s and variable x ;*

5. there exist an operator symbol F in Σ with an introductory rule

$$y_1 : B_1, \dots, y_m : B_m \vdash F : B$$

and sequents

$$\begin{aligned} \Gamma \vdash t_1 : B_1 \\ \Gamma \vdash t_2 : B_2[y_1 \leftarrow t_1] \\ \vdots \\ \Gamma \vdash t_m : B_m[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_{m-1} \leftarrow t_{m-1}] \end{aligned}$$

such that t is equal to $F[y_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, y_m \leftarrow t_m]$.

Proof. By simultaneous induction on $|\pi|$ with Lemma 2.14.

Group I: Direct Term Introduction Rules

ASS $t = x \in \text{Var}(\Gamma)$. This is Case 1.

PI-INTRO $t = (\lambda x : B)s$ and $A = (\Pi x : B)C$. The premise is a strict sub-derivation. This is Case 2.

PI-ELIM $t = \text{App}([x : B]C, f, r)$ and $A = C[x \leftarrow r]$. Premises are strict sub-derivations. This is Case 3.

VI-INTRO $t = (\forall x : B)p$ and $A = \text{Prop}$. This is Case 4.

INTRODUCTORY RULE For an operator $F \in \Sigma$, $t = F[z_1 \leftarrow t_1, \dots, z_w \leftarrow t_w]$ with all premises as strict sub-derivations. This is Case 5.

Group II: Context-Structural Rules

These preserve the syntactic form of t ; only the context and type representative change.

EQU Apply the induction hypothesis to $\Delta \vdash t : A$. Transfer each sub-derivation from context Δ to Γ using EQU (and CEQU where necessary). All cases transfer safely.

THIN Apply the induction hypothesis to $\Gamma, \Delta \vdash t : A$. Transfer sub-derivations using THIN (using CONT-THIN for extended contexts), valid by PROP. All cases transfer.

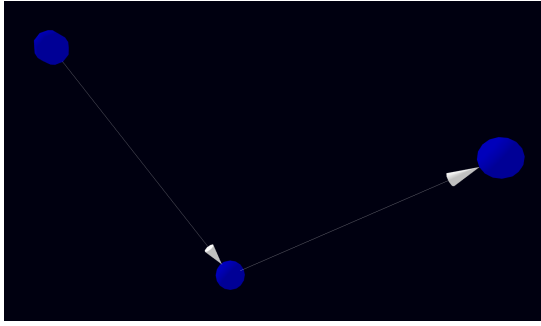
SUB Apply the induction hypothesis to $\Gamma, y : B, \Delta \vdash t : A$. Substitution is transparent to the outermost constructor of t . If $t = x = y$, then $t[y \leftarrow s] = s$. Extend $\Gamma \vdash s : B$ by THIN and apply the induction hypothesis to $\Gamma \vdash s : B$ (smaller height) to recursively determine the form of s .

Group III: Type-Conversion and Equality Rules

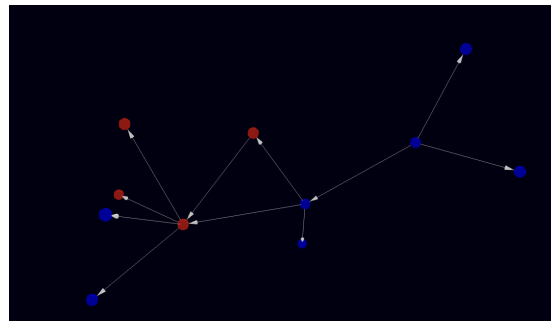
- CONV1** Apply the induction hypothesis to $\Gamma \vdash t : A'$ (smaller height). The syntactic form of t is unchanged; we propagate the type claim from A' to A using provable equality $\Gamma \vdash A' = A$ and **TRANS-TYP**. For example, in Case 2, A' is provably equal to $(\Pi x : B)C$, and by transitivity, A is provably equal to $(\Pi x : B)C$.
- REFL-OBJ** By inner induction on the derivation of term equality. If derived from $\Gamma \vdash t : A$, it is shorter (apply outer induction hypothesis). If derived by **TRANS-OBJ**, the companion term-equality lemma determines the form. If derived by β -RULE or η -RULE, t maps directly to Case 3 or Case 2, respectively. $\square$

Appendix C

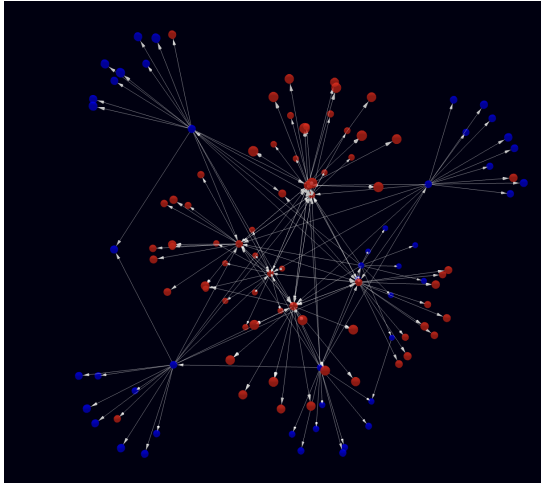
Figures



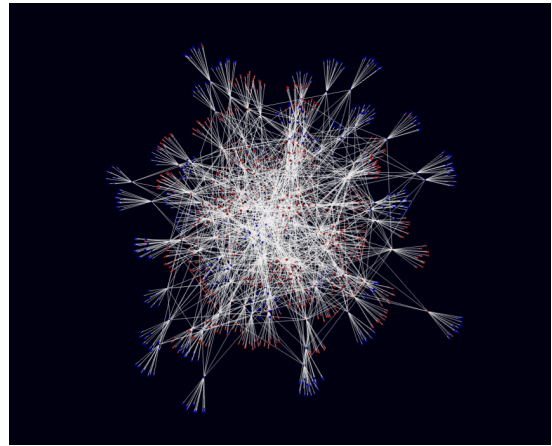
(a) The G_1 subcategory



(b) The G_2 subcategory



(c) The G_3 subcategory



(d) The G_4 subcategory

Figure C.1: Overview of the G_1 through G_4 subcategories. Nodes represent propositions. They are blue if they have no witness or proof, and they are red if they have one. Edges are implications between propositions, i.e., there is an edge between nodes P and Q if there is a proof of $P \rightarrow Q$.

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